

Top honours

Eminent personalities from Tamil Nadu who received the Padma awards for their outstanding contributions in various fields at Rashtrapati Bhavan on Monday



► **Padma Shri awardees** (from left): Former Health Minister H.V. Hande (Medicine), N. Swaminathan (Art), R. Sreedher (Others-Radio Broadcasting), Tamil author Sivasankari (Literature and Education), former CRPF Director-General K. Vijay Kumar (Civil Service); and a family member of R. Krishnan Kitna (Art-posthumous) receiving the award. PTI



► **Gastroenterologist K.R. Palaniswamy** receiving the Padma Bhushan (Medicine) from President Droupadi Murmu in New Delhi on Monday. ANI

From Page One

Opposition criticises CM Vijay over a spate of crimes across T.N.

A. Gubendran, 17, was stabbed to death in the early hours of Monday at the Madurai Corporation's shopping complex in the Meenakshi Sundareswarar Temple parking lot. A scuffle with M. Muthumani, 28, over buying bananas at his shop on Dhavalai Street on April 26 is said to have led to the murder. The Vilakkuthoon police have picked up five suspects: Muthumani; his brother Rajkumar, 26; Satheesh Kumar, 28; Harikrishnan, 18; and Muthukumar, 19.

Molotov cocktail attack

In Coimbatore district, four motorcycle-borne men hurled Molotov cocktails at the house of a girl near Thondamuthur on Sunday. Thondamuthur inspector T. Shanmugavel said one of the persons involved in the attack hailed from Chennai and was a serial offender. He and three of his friends carried out the attack, allegedly after the girl distanced herself from him. The police were trying to arrest them, the inspector added.

Three men were arrested on Sunday after a 25-year-old woman filed a complaint at the Thoothukudi All Women Police Station, alleging sexual assault.

The police said the accused – A. Mohith, 25; J. Ritheesh, 19; and J. Thiloth Berlin, 21 – hailed from Fathima Nagar in Thoothukudi. Mohith, who was known to the woman, had taken her to the crime spot, near the fishing harbour, late on Saturday. There, he and his two friends allegedly sexually assaulted her.

Act of vandalism

Mr. Udhayanidhi also referred to an incident in Perambur, the constituency represented by the Chief Minister, where a gang of drug-peddlers allegedly vandalised cars.

Mr. Palaniswami expressed shock over the incidents and urged Mr. Vijay to uphold law and order. Among the incidents he referred to are the sexual harassment of a girl in Madurai allegedly involving a ruling TVK functionary, the alleged harassment of a college student by a TVK functionary in Chennai, and the alleged harassment of an electricity engineer by TVK functionaries at Tiruvottiyur.

The AIADMK leader also referred to reports on the death of a couple who tried to pass through a railway subway inundated by heavy rain at Omalur in Salem district.

‘Vijay a mute spectator’

AMMK founder T.T.V. Dhinakaran criticised the government over the sexual assault on minors. Recalling Mr. Vijay's statement when the sexual assault of a student at Anna University was reported during DMK rule, Mr. Dhinakaran asked, “Why is Mr. Vijay remaining indifferent and acting as a mute spectator to offences against women after becoming the Chief Minister?”

BJP State president Nainar Nagenthiran said, “Only the government has changed, but the woes continue.”

He also criticised Mr. Vijay for having “instigated” children to press their parents to vote for him and for having assured them that he was their “uncle”, but remaining a mere “spectator” while children were being sexually assaulted.

It’s horse-trading at speed of a horse, says Stalin on AIADMK MLAs joining TVK

Those who proclaimed themselves to be a clean force have become a ‘tragic force’, he says, and accuses the TVK of engineering the resignation of three AIADMK MLAs from S.P. Velumani group

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

DMK president and former Chief Minister M.K. Stalin on Monday described the resignation of three AIADMK MLAs and their immediate meeting with Minister Aadhav Arjuna at the Secretariat to join the Tamilaga Vetttri Kazhagam (TVK) as “horse-trading at horse speed.”

“Those who proclaimed themselves to be a clean force (the TVK) have now been thoroughly exposed. They have become a tragic force,” Mr. Stalin said in a social media message.

He said the TVK, “in the first scene, sought the support of leaders of the DMK’s alliance partners and, in the second scene, bargained with a section of AIADMK MLAs and a lone MLA of the AMMK during the trust vote.” “In the third scene, it has engineered the resignation of AIADMK MLAs and made them join the party in the



M.K. Stalin

Secretariat itself. Did people vote for you just to witness these unsavoury scenes?” he asked.

Mr. Stalin said the drama unfolding now had exposed the “fake anti-BJP stand” of the Congress, which had joined the TVK government after saying it would extend support only if the TVK refrained from seeking the support of the NDA.

‘Vulgar politics’

AIADMK general secretary Edappadi K. Palaniswami condemned what he termed as “vulgar politics” and “horse-trading” intro-

duced by the ruling TVK. Any attempt to defeat and replace the AIADMK would remain a dream, he said.

A cinema celebrity, who claimed to bring about purity in politics, has resorted to “underhand dealings” to save his government, which was a matter of “shame”, Mr. Palaniswami said without mentioning anyone.

The act of resignation of three MLAs on the ground floor of the Secretariat-cum-Assembly complex, and within a few minutes, receiving party membership from a TVK Minister on the first floor, only exposed a pre-meditated drama and the attempts of “horse-trading”.

“The underhanded dealings of the TVK government is a new approach in Tamil Nadu politics. The AIADMK has been a great movement serving the people, tolerating acts of betrayal and back-stabbing. The MLAs who support the government or those who have re-

signed now should not forget that they contested against the symbol of the cinema celebrity,” Mr. Palaniswami said.

Mr. Palaniswami also removed party functionary Thaiyur S. Kumaravel from all positions, including the party’s primary membership. He said the actions of Mr. Kumaravel were not in line with the party’s discipline and further brought disrepute to the party.

Meanwhile, AMMK founder T.T.V. Dhinakaran referred to the charges of “horse-trading” he made earlier, and contended that his charges were turning out to be true.

‘Unethical act’

PMK president Anbumani Ramadoss said the MLAs had resigned only to join the ruling party and enjoy the benefits of power.

Former VCK MLA from Thirupporur S.S. Balaji said the act of the three MLAs was unethical and that “entertaining them would be dangerous”.

Ex-VCK MLA threatens to leave party over its support for TVK

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Despite joining Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay’s Cabinet, the Viduthalai Chiruthaigal Katchi (VCK) has been facing sustained criticism for not being true to its “ideological roots” from its own comrades.

On Sunday, former VCK MLA “Panaiyur” Babu wrote to the party leader expressing his desire to leave the party, as the leader operated “without ideological clarity and is stumbling along”.

‘Panaiyur’ Babu said VCK leader Thol. Thirumavalavan operated without ideological clarity

In a statement, Mr. Babu said VCK leader Thol. Thirumavalavan took different stands on the same issue. “[He] took one stand yesterday, another one in a television interview, another at the press conference and contradicted the same on a Facebook live. Yesterday, you [Thirumavalavan]

called the actor [Vijay] the child of “BJP and RSS”. Today, you have adopted that child, proving that you have begun to waver in your ideological stance.”

VCK general secretary Sinthanai Selvan urged Mr. Babu to reconsider his decision. “What you said regarding the party’s decisions cannot be ignored, but our leader’s decision is not out of self-interest. He has sacrificed his youth to achieve the dream of social equality... Please place your criticisms in front of our leader,” he said.

Mekedatu dam issue: CM tells officials to pursue legal action

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay instructed officials to pursue continued legal action regarding the Mekedatu dam issue during a meeting with Cauvery river water experts and legal luminaries at the Secretariat on Monday.

Following the Karnataka government’s proposal for a *bhoomi pooja* for the construction of the dam, the Chief Minister held a consultative meeting to uphold Tamil Nadu’s



C. Joseph Vijay

rights, a release said.

The meeting was also attended by Ministers N. Anand, Aadhav Arjuna, and R. Nirmalkumar, and senior officials.

During the meeting, it

was pointed out that on November 11, 2025, the Supreme Court, while ruling on the lawsuits filed by the Tamil Nadu government opposing the Mekedatu project, disposed of the matter by stating that only the Central Water Commission, comprising experts, could determine whether the project complied with previous judgments.

The release said Mr. Vijay, taking the judgments into consideration, directed that actions subsequent to the detailed legal consultation be expedited.

Police expedite probe into sexual assault and murder of girl

Wilson Thomas
COIMBATORE

The police have expedited the investigation into the sexual assault-cum-murder of a 10-year-old girl near Suler in Coimbatore district, aiming to submit the charge sheet within a month.

Inspector-General of Police (West Zone) R.V. Ramya Bharathi convened a meeting with Deputy Inspector-General of Police (Coimbatore Range) P. Saminathan, Coimbatore District (Rural) Superintendent of Police Allatipalli Pavan Kumar Reddy, Additional SP M. Vivekanandan and members of the inves-

tigating team on Monday.

The investigating team comprises Deputy Superintendent of Police (DSP) Karikal Pari Shankar, five Inspectors, and 10-15 Sub-Inspectors. Perur DSP S. Suresh will assist Mr. Shankar.

Officers were assigned different tasks to wrap up the investigation at the earliest. The progress will be reviewed on a daily basis, Ms. Bharathi said.

On the forensic side, the police are awaiting the postmortem and viscera analysis reports.

A potency test is likely to be conducted on the main accused in the case, K. Karthi, 33.

Man sentenced to death for sexual assault, murder of Class XII girl in Thoothukudi

The Hindu Bureau
THOOTHUKUDI

The Special Court for POCSO Act cases in Thoothukudi, on Monday, sentenced a man to death on two counts after finding him guilty in the sexual assault and murder of a Class XII girl in Thoothukudi district in March.

The girl had gone missing in a scrub forest area, around 250 metres from her residence, on the evening of March 10, and was found dead on March 11. The Kulathur police had recovered the body and sent it for a post-mortem examination to Thoothukudi Government Medical College and Hospital.

Following the incident,



Dharma Muneeswaran being brought from the court after the sentencing. N. RAJESH

the victim’s parents and villagers staged a protest demanding the arrest of the accused and action against the Kulathur and Vilathikulam police for allegedly failing to take prompt action.

After a week-long hunt, the accused, Dharma Muneeswaran, 38, of Sayalku-

di in Ramanathapuram district, was arrested on March 19.

Then Superintendent of Police, Thoothukudi district, C. Madhan had said evidence leading to the arrest of Muneeswaran was gathered through scientific investigation.

Following the arrest, Dharma Muneeswaran was remanded in judicial custody at the central prison in Palayamkottai, before being shifted to Madurai prison due to safety concerns.

The case was presided over by II Additional District Judge M. Breetha. Special Prosecutor V. Elammal said 71 witnesses were examined between May 5 and May 22.

The prosecution sub-

mitted 19 material objects and 117 documentary evidences before the court.

Holding the accused guilty, the court awarded him two death penalties and one year’s imprisonment under Sections 104 and 127(2) of the BNS and Section 6 of the POCSO Act.

IG hails verdict

Inspector-General of Police (IGP) Vijayendra Bidari said the double death sentence awarded by the court reaffirmed faith in the criminal justice system.

Mr. Bidari said the trial proceedings in the case were completed in 54 days, resulting in the highest punishment for the accused.

T.N. govt. announces cooperative crop loan waiver up to ₹50,000

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Tamil Nadu government headed by Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay, on Monday, announced a waiver on loans up to ₹50,000, availed by small and marginal farmers from cooperative banks since May last year.

Loans up to ₹50,000 obtained by marginal farmers will be completely waived. For small farmers, 50% of the loan within this limit will be waived. Marginal farmers who borrowed ₹50,000-₹60,000, will receive a waiver of ₹40,000, and small farmers in the same bracket ₹20,000.

As the loan amount increases, the quantum of the amount waived will decrease. Small and marginal farmers who borrowed more than ₹1 lakh will be provided a flat waiver of ₹5,000. Besides, other large-scale farmers who obtained crop loans through cooperative banks will receive a uniform waiver of ₹5,000 each.

The government said 14,22,555 farmers who availed crop loans from cooperative banks between May 1, 2025, and February 28, 2026, will benefit from this scheme, imposing an additional expenditure of ₹2,044.46 crore on the government.

INBRIEF



Census 2027 training begins for Corporation officials

Training for Greater Chennai Corporation (GCC) officials for Census 2027 began in the city on Monday. The training session was presided over by Sunderesh Babu, Director of Census Operations, Tamil Nadu, in the presence of GCC Commissioner and Principal Census Officer G. S. Sameeran. Training sessions are scheduled from May 25 to May 27. Master trainers appointed by the Directorate of Census Operations trained officials. Deputy Commissioner (Revenue and Finance) and City Census Officer M. Prithiviraj was present at the meeting.

Ensure release of water from Mettur dam on June 12: Vasan

Tamil Maanila Congress (Moopanar) leader G.K. Vasan on Monday urged the State government to release water from the Mettur dam on the customary date of June 12. He referred to representations received from farmers in this regard.

Text & Context and Science

Weekday features on *The Hindu* epaper (epaper.thehindu.com) carry explainers, special articles and quizzes. In the latest issue (May 26, Tuesday), the following articles are available:

- Why is the Indian rupee falling?
[newsth.live/g1opoh/rupee/falling](#)
- How physicists are finding new ways to make electrons act strangely
[newsth.live/electrons](#)

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Major fire breaks out at oil godown in city

Officials say the blaze intensified as oil cans stored inside the warehouse kept exploding, making it difficult for firefighters to approach the site

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

A major fire broke out at a private oil godown in Manali on Monday.

Thick smoke billowed from a private oil godown belonging to Sri Sathya Sai Oil Lubricants at Rajiv Gandhi Nagar in Vichoor near Manali and the fire destroyed several oil cans stored at the facility. Upon receipt of the information, personnel from Fire and Rescue Services rushed to the spot with water tankers and other materials to put out the fire.

Fire services personnel could not approach the spot as the fire was massive, and the flames had spread to other premises as well. One woman sustained burns in the incident.

Fire and Rescue Services personnel continued fire-fighting operations until evening as thick smoke engulfed the locality. According to sources, the blaze erupted at the warehouse, where waste oil and lubricant materials were stored. A few workers present on the premises noticed the fire and immediately evacuated before alerting the Fire and Rescue Services department.

Firefighters from Manali, Ennore, and Tiruvottiyur rushed to the spot and launched operations to



Battling the blaze: Fire and Rescue Services personnel trying to put out the fire at a godown in Manali. B. JOTHI RAMALINGAM

Two Fire and Rescue Services personnel collapsed after inhaling smoke and were hospitalised

contain the blaze.

Officials said the fire intensified as oil cans stored inside the warehouse exploded, making it difficult for the personnel to approach the site initially. Dense black smoke billowed from the site and was visible from several kilometres away.

Police sources said the company's main manufacturing unit functions in Coimbatore, while the Vichoor facility was primarily used as a storage and transport warehouse. Offi-

cials added that only a few workers and a watchman were usually present on the premises. Sources further said the facility had earlier been sealed following court directions and had resumed operations only recently. During the fire-fighting operation, two firefighters reportedly collapsed after inhaling dense smoke. They were rescued by fellow personnel, administered first aid and admitted to a nearby hospital.

Officials confirmed that the fire did not spread to neighbouring factories and no casualties were reported. Manali New Town police are monitoring the situation and an inquiry is under way to ascertain the cause of the fire.



Health Minister K.G. Arunraj said the current stock position in warehouses across the city and districts was already available online. B. JOTHI RAMALINGAM

Minister inspects TNMSC warehouse

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Health Minister K.G. Arunraj on Monday inspected a warehouse of the Tamil Nadu Medical Services Corporation (TNMSC) in Anna Nagar.

Dr. Arunraj told reporters that the Anna Nagar warehouse was the largest facility in Chennai from where drugs and medical equipment required for all government hospitals functioning inside Greater Chennai Corporation limits are supplied. Noting that there was scope to further improve the system, he said the current stock position in warehouses across the city and districts was available online. The next step, he added, was to have real-time stock positions at the hospital level, including primary health centres, taluk hospitals, and government medical college hospitals.

“With the war situation in the Middle East, a review was held to discuss precautionary measures in

case of shortages in drug supplies and to plan how to manage if shortages of essential raw materials used in drug manufacturing arises,” he said.

The Minister said that power supply was crucial for functioning of equipment, such as ventilators, in hospitals.

In the future, uninterrupted power supply in both government and private hospitals will be ensured through inter-department coordination as per the Chief Minister's directions, he said, adding that they have already spoken to the Electricity Minister and Secretary.

Dr. Arunraj said that issuance of licenses for 8,000 private hospitals, including small-sized clinics, were pending since 2019 under the Tamil Nadu Clinical Establishments Act. He also pointed to an audit objection raised regarding delay in granting licenses. If these licenses were issued in 2019, an annual licensing fee of ₹5,000 would have been obtained.

Man arrested for sexually harassing minor girl in Ambattur

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Ambattur Industrial Estate police have arrested a 36-year-old man for allegedly sexually harassing a minor girl after entering her house by posing as an employee of the Electricity Department to attend to a fault.

According to a complaint lodged with the police, the incident happened on May 20, when the nine-year-old girl was alone at her home. Police said the man, posing as an Electricity Department employee, barged into the house.

Silver anklets snatched
After sexually harassing the child, the man snatched her silver anklets and fled the spot. Her parents lodged a complaint with the Ambattur Industrial Estate police.

The police identified the man as Balaji of Tondiarpet after checking CCTV camera footage. They traced the man to Red Hills and apprehended him. The police also recovered the anklets and a bike that was used during the crime. Balaji was booked under the provisions of the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) Act and the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita. He was remanded in judicial custody. The police said he was involved in a series of robberies.

THE HINDU

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PUBLIC NOTICE

PUBLIC NOTICE

CHANGE OF NAME

I, ASHWINI, s/o Mr. Ilango, aged about 32 years, residing at No-23, 1st Street, Surya Nagar, K.Pudur, Madurai - 625007, have changed my name to Ashwin Ilango vide affidavit dated 19.05.2026 sworn before S. Praveen Kumar, Notary Public at Chennai. I shall henceforth be known as Ashwin Ilango for all purposes.

MY SON, Koduru Kushal, Son of Thiru. Koduru Sarath, born on 16th October 2022, (District of Birth Chennai) residing at Old No.8/1, New No.10, 6th Cross, Kamaraj Street, West, Gandhi Nagar, Avadi Post, Chennai-600 054, shall henceforth be known as Koduru Kushyarth - Gonna Bathula Balasree (Mother)

I. K.S. KISHORE KUMAAR, S/o Thiru C. KUMARALAGU & Thirumathi K.SIVAGAMI, R/o S1, Nakshatra Apt., Thirupathi Kodai St, Kalaiavanar Nagar, Athipet, Ambattur, Chennai-600058, converted from Hinduism to Christianity on 02.01.2022 at Perinba Prayer Assembly, Mugappair, Chennai-600037, and Changed Name to K.S.JADEN JESU. Henceforth known as K.S.JADEN JESU. Vide Affidavit sworn before Notary Public at Chennai on 18.05.2026

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Our client is the owner of the land measuring a total extent of 1 Acre and 21.50 Cents comprised in S.No.116/2A (measuring 0.18 Acre), S.No.116/2B and as per Patta S.No.116/2B2 (measuring 0.32 Acre), S.No.116/2C (measuring 0.23 Acre), S.No.116/3 and as per Patta S.No.116/3A (measuring 0.085 Acre), S.No.116/4 (measuring 0.20 Acre) and S.No.116/5B (measuring 0.20 Acre) situated at Vengaivasal Village, Tambaram Taluk, Chengalpattu District, relating to which status of 3 parent documents is : (i) Original Sale Deed dated 20.07.1965 registered as Document No.2588 of 1965 and (ii) Original Sale Deed dated 14.08.1995 registered as Document No.2962 of 1995, both on the file of the Sub-Registrar Office, Tambaram, being an old parent documents, are presently not available; however, their certified copies are available; and (iii) Duplicate copy of Sale Deed dated 27.05.1996 registered as Document No.4463 of 1996 on the file of the Sub-Registrar Office, Tambaram, is not available; however, the original registered document is available.

Attention is invited to public if anyone possesses these documents, the same may kindly be brought to the notice of our client within 10 days from this day.

MAHIMA MAKHIJA
Advocate for RSSB
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Place: Chennai
Date: 25.05.2026

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2.	KKRTC/2024-25/ IND0125/CALL-7	Procurement of Oil Seals.	0.90 Crore	10.06.2026 at 15.00 hrs
3.	KKRTC/2025-26/ IND0192/CALL-2	Procurement of Thin walled Bearings.	0.70 Crore	10.06.2026 at 15.00 hrs
4.	KKRTC/2026-27/ IND0208	Procurement of Fasteners	0.94 Crore	10.06.2026 at 15.00 hrs
5.	KKRTC/2026-27/ IND0209	Supply of Curing Envelops and Curing Bags	0.58 Crore	10.06.2026 at 15.00 hrs
6.	KKRTC/2024-25/ IND0119/CALL-7	Procurement of Fuel Injection pipes & Leak off pipes	0.41 Crore	10.06.2026 at 15.00 hrs
7.	KKRTC/2026-27/ IND0207	Procurement of Head Lamp Assemblies and Accessories	4.02 Crore	22.06.2026 at 15.00 hrs
8.	KKRTC/2026-27/ IND0206	Supply of Desktop Computers, Laptops, Printers & Tabs	3.14 Crore	22.06.2026 at 15.00 hrs
9.	KKRTC/2026-27/ IND0212	Supply of First Aid Box with Medicine	0.35 Crore	22.06.2026 at 15.00 hrs
10.	KKRTC/2026-27/ IND0211	Supply of Fire detection & Suppression System(FDSS)	0.40 Crore	22.06.2026 at 15.00 hrs
11.	KKRTC/2026-27/ IND0203	Supply of Automotive Grease	3.49 Crore.	27.06.2026 at 15.00 hrs
12.	KKRTC/2026-27/ IND0205	Supply of PCTR & Allied Materials	11.02 Crore	27.06.2026 at 15.00 hrs
13.	KKRTC/2026-27/ SE8553	Engaging an agency for providing technical assistants to the divisions of KKRTC	9.52 Crore	27.06.2026 at 15.00 hrs
14.	KKRTC/2026-27/ SE8258-CALL-2	Identifying agency for providing IT Staff (Software & System Engineer on contract basis to KKRTC.	0.39 Crore	27.06.2026 at 15.00 hrs
15.	KKRTC/2025-26/ IND0176/CALL-3	Supply of Fan Belts	0.38 Crore	10.06.2026 at 15.00 hrs
16.	KKRTC/2024-25/ IND0101/CALL-5	Supply of Piston Assembly and Ring Sets	0.89 Crore	10.06.2026 at 15.00 hrs
17.	KKRTC/2026-27/ IND0213	Supply of King pin Components & Stub Axles	2.13 Crore	27.06.2026 at 15.00 hrs

All the details of Tender, Registration, Tender form documents etc. are available at [https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in/](#) /Mail to [cospnkrct@gmail.com](#) or [support@eprocelpdesk.com](#) for further information if required. Further, any addendum /corrigendum related to changes in terms and conditions of tender, specification and calendar of events etc. will be uploaded only through KPP portal.

Sd/- Controller of Stores and Purchases
(Tender Inviting Authority)
DIPR/Kalaburagi/158/Deshpande Publicity/2026-27

INBRIEF



National workshop on imaging innovations held

SRM Global Hospitals in association with SRM Medical College Hospital and Research Centre recently organised a one-day national workshop on the latest imaging innovations for the diagnosis and treatment of complex gastrointestinal disorders. Over 100 gastroenterology consultants, postgraduate trainees, academicians, and faculty members from across the country participated. The workshop focussed on developments in gastroenterology and minimally invasive therapeutic procedures, with special emphasis on advanced endoscopic ultrasound applications in gastrointestinal diagnostics and treatment. R. Jayanthi, dean, SRM Medical College Hospital and Research Centre and Vinay Dhir, chairman of the India EUS Club inaugurated the workshop. V. P. Chandrasekaran, chief operating officer and Swaminathan, medical superintendent, SRM Global Hospitals were also present.

Timings CHENNAI

TUESDAY, MAY. 26		
RISE	05:42	SET 18:30
RISE	14:30	SET 01:59
WEDNESDAY, MAY. 27		
RISE	05:42	SET 18:31
RISE	15:18	SET 02:35
THURSDAY, MAY. 28		
RISE	05:42	SET 18:31
RISE	16:07	SET 03:13

Chennai Weather

	max	min
Tiruvallur	41	26
Chennai Airport	41	30
Chennai City	39	29

Chennai Airport Today
35°C Day will be warm with uneasy afternoon. Night will be uneasy. Chances of light rain and thundershower.

Chennai Airport Tomorrow
36°C The weather will be dry. Day will be very warm and uneasy with moderate winds. Night will remain uneasy.

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Five screenings a day of Tamil films for one week from release

The Hindu Bureau CHENNAI

The Government of Tamil Nadu has issued an order permitting all movie theatres across the state to screen five shows daily for the first seven days from the release date of a new Tamil film.

Additionally, theatres are allowed to run five daily shows on local festival days, public holidays, Saturdays, and Sundays.

Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay has directed that no separate permission from the government or licensing authorities is required for this purpose.

Representatives from the film industry recently met with Mr. Vijay and placed several demands before him. Chief among them was the request to allow five shows per day for all movies in theatres across the State. Currently, theatres in Tamil Nadu op-

Theatres can also run five daily shows on local festival days, public holidays, and weekends

erate four shows everyday. Under existing rules, to screen an additional special show (making it five shows a day) on local festival days or public holidays, separate special permission had to be obtained.

In response to the film industry's requests, an amendment has been made to the Tamil Nadu Cinemas (Regulation) Rules.

Accordingly, it has been announced that all theatres in Tamil Nadu are permitted to screen five shows daily for seven days from the release date of newly released Tamil films, as well as on local festival days, public holidays, Saturdays, and Sundays.

Police seize 170 kg of ganja

CHENNAI: The Tambaram City Police seized 170 kg of ganja and arrested four persons during a vehicle check on Sunday. The arrested were Palla Varahala Babu, 35, Galla Sathya Narayana, 29, Senapathi Durga Prasad, 24, and Vankala Durga Prasad, 23, all from Andhra Pradesh.

A maze of utility lines shifted for constructing underground metro station at Purasawalkam

Officials said moving utility lines at Purasawalkam has been the most difficult task in Phase II network as road width was limited compared to other locations; all utility lines such as power cables, sewer and metro water pipelines were clustered in the station box area, making the process arduous

TRACK TALES

Sunitha Sekar CHENNAI

At Purasawalkam, under the bustling shopping hub of the city, when Chennai Metro Rail commenced work to build an underground station for the phase II project a few years ago, it ran into a maze of utility lines, the kind it had not encountered elsewhere.

In the 118.9-km Phase II network, shifting of utility lines such as power cables, sewer and metro water pipelines have been a routine process despite some setbacks.

According to officials of Chennai Metro Rail Limit-

ed (CMRL), the upcoming Purasawalkam High Road Metro Station is being constructed under the busy Purasawalkam Junction.

“Moving the utility lines at Purasawalkam has been the most difficult task so far in the Phase II network. This is because of multiple reasons. In this busy high-density commercial hub, the road width was far more limited compared to the other locations and all the lines were clustered in the station box area. The lines and cables were not running parallel to the station box alone; they were criss-crossing the box and shaft. We had to seek multiple traffic diversions to carry out the work and gradually relocate the lines and cables which took



Tough task: CMRL had to seek multiple traffic diversions to carry out the work, which took nearly three years. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

nearly three years,” an official said.

These issues aside, what made shifting the utilities here tougher was, unlike most of the stations whose length ranges from 135

metres to 150 metres, at Purasawalkam, it exceeded 300 metres.

Along with the station box, they had to build crossover boxes too, a critical technical feature that al-

lows trains to switch tracks.

“In most of the other stations, the utilities were not as bunched up and we had to relocate them for a maximum of 150 metres. Nearly 100 power cables, two water pipelines with 1,000-mm diameter, a 1,000-mm, 900-mm, 600-mm, and 300-mm diameter sewer lines were among the lines we moved. Though we received the map of these utilities in advance before beginning the work, we were surprised to discover the alignment of the lines sometimes didn't match with the map that the respective agency had shared with us. These unchartered utility lines made the job much more complex. We successfully

finished moving these lines nearly nine months back,” a source said.

While the station is built at a depth of 21 metres, these utility lines were located at a depth of 2-3 metres at Purasawalkam. “It required manual excavation until the utilities were moved which doesn't happen in other locations. Heavy duty equipment called trench cutters will usually be used for station excavation work. After the three metre depth, trench cutters were deployed,” he added. While some of the lines have been permanently moved, the ones which were shifted temporarily will be restored to the original position when the station work is completed in two years.

T.S. Anbu appointed ADGP Law and Order; Arun to head DVAC

S. Vijay Kumar CHENNAI

The Tamil Nadu government, on Monday, posted Additional Director-General of Police T.S. Anbu as the ADGP, Law and Order, replacing Maheshwar Dayal, who has been transferred to the Administration Wing of the police headquarters as its head.

Mr. Anbu, a 2001-batch IPS officer, currently on compulsory wait, was heading the Crime Branch-CID of the State police until recently. He will take charge of the sensitive post amid incidents of murder, sexual offences, and other



T.S. Anbu

serious crimes reported across the State.

Mr. Anbu is the recipient of the Tamil Nadu Chief Minister's Police Medal for Excellence in Public Service. He has served in the Greater Chennai Police in various capacities such



A. Arun

as the Deputy Commissioner of Police, the Joint Commissioner of Police, and the Additional Commissioner of Police.

Mr. Anbu was part of “Operation Puttur”, in which the Tamil Nadu and Andhra Pradesh Police ar-

rested Panna Ismail, Bilal Malik, and others owing allegiance to Al Ummah, a banned communal outfit.

The State government also posted the former Chennai Police Commissioner, A. Arun, as Director, Directorate of Vigilance and Anti-Corruption (DVAC), Chennai.

He was on compulsory wait after the Election Commission shifted him during the Model Code of Conduct ahead of the Assembly election.

Mr. Arun earlier served in different capacities such as the ADGP, Law and Order, and Commissioner of Police, Avadi.

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY
TENDER NOTICE
No. DNR/S&T/Sig/2026/6 Danapur, dtd. 21.05.2026
Divisional Railway Manager (Signal & Telecom), East Central Railway, Danapur Division, for and on behalf of President of India invites tenders on web portal www.ireps.gov.in for the following work:-
1. Name of work with its location: Provision of RD50 approved make aspiration type fire alarm system for replacing Non-RD50 Fire alarm system at 30 station under Danapur Division.,
2. Approximate cost of work : Rs.30437104.00, 3. Earnest Money: Rs. 608800.00, 4. Last Date & Time of Submission: Up to 15.00 hrs. on 15.06.2026, 5. Opening of tender: 15.00 hrs. on 15.06.2026, 6. Website Particulars where detail of the work and criteria can be seen: www.ireps.gov.in, 7. Address of the office from where detail information can be obtained: Sr. Divnl. Signal & Telecommunication Engineer, East Central Railway, Danapur
Note: Any Corrigendum if required will be uploaded on above website before 14 days.
Divisional Signal & Telecom Engineer
East Central Railway, Danapur
PR/0286/DNR/S&T/T/26-27/36

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY
ADVERTISEMENT OF TENDER
Batch No- 07/26 Dated-22.05.2026
For and on behalf of the President of India, the Principal Chief Materials Manager, East Central Railway invites e-tenders for supply of the following items:
Sl. No : 1, Tender No. : 04264838, Brief Description: Axle Box Pivot Bush, Quantity: 8999 Nos, Due Date : 18.06.2026, Due Time : 14:00
Sl. No : 2, Tender No. : 14250331A, Brief Description: Disconnecting and Earthing Device 8 Pole 2 Way without OFF, ON Load 125A, Quantity: 183 Nos, Due Date : 15.06.2026, Due Time : 14:00
Sl. No : 3, Tender No. : 11254865A, Brief Description: Inhibited Mineral Insulation Oil shall, Quantity: 63528.667 Ltr., Due Date : 15.06.2026, Due Time : 14:00
Sl. No : 4, Tender No. : 14265013, Brief Description: 10 KVA 25 KV/240V, 1-Phase, Oil Type Auxiliary Transformer complete, Quantity: 234 Nos, Due Date : 15.06.2026, Due Time : 14:00
Sl. No : 5, Tender No. : 14255052, Brief Description: 21.6/30.24 MVA, 132/27 KV, Traction Power Transformer, Quantity: 3 Set, Due Date : 22.06.2026, Due Time : 14:00
Note: All the above-mentioned tenders are e-tenders and all tenderers are requested to submit their bids on-line through the IREPS website at www.ireps.gov.in. All corrigendum to above-mentioned tenders shall also be published online in IREPS website only. For more details regarding the above-mentioned tenders and other supply tenders please visit IREPS website.
AMM-cum Secy to PCMM
E.C. Railway, Hajipur
PR/0287/HQ/STORE/T/26-27/52

S. E. RAILWAY E- TENDER					
Tender Notice No. PCMM/GENL/TP/2026/20			Dated: 22/05/2026		
The Principal Chief Materials Manager, South Eastern Railway, Hd. Qrs. Office (5th Floor), New administrative Building, 11, Garden Reach Road, Kolkata-700043 for and on behalf of the President of India invites open E-tenders which have been uploaded on website www.ireps.gov.in as follows. All the tenders will be Closed at 14.00 hrs.					
Sl. No.	Tender No.	Closing Date	Brief Description	Qty.	EMD (In Rs.)
1	77261755	11/06/26	Set of Fluoropolymer Paints consisting of 02 items etc.	900 Set.	1,01,960/-
2	SERKGPW-TDAK-26-27	15/06/26	Fixed Remuneration per month for Attendant including GST.	288 Man Month.	2,03,600/-
			Statutory EPF including GST.	288 Man Month.	
			Service Charges.	288 Man Month.	
3	GEM/2026/B/7561685	19/06/26	Aerial Bunched Cable For Working Voltage etc.	65000 Mtr.	1,81,020/-
4	46253097B	24/06/26	Motor Protection Circuit Breaker (MPCB) etc.	3031 Nos.	1,17,170/-
5	45261632	30/06/26	SUPPLY OF 90 AH LOW MAINTENANCE LEAD ACID BATTERY etc.	47 Set.	1,16,760/-
6	75261790A	23/06/26	FLEXIBLE POLY VINYL CHLORIDE (PVC) FLOORING SHEET etc.	3356 Nos.	11,72,080/-
7	38263129	12/06/26	Kit for Dirt Collector consisting of 3 items in a set.	130718 Set.	84,740/-
8	38261563	17/06/26	Distributor valve (C.I. Version for freight application).	1229 Nos.	6,36,280/-
9	38261535	19/06/26	POH Kit 'B' for High Tensile CBC Draft Gear type RF-361.	850 Set.	5,21,560/-
10	38264079	24/06/26	Constant Contact side Bearer Assembly (Spring loaded type) Variant 'C'.	4755 Nos.	6,94,180/-
11	38263898	24/06/26	Slack adjuster Type IRSA-600 complete.	1850 Nos.	3,28,280/-
12	38263959	24/06/26	New Doorway Stiffening Cross Bar for BOXN Wagon.	14460 Nos.	5,63,080/-
13	38261575B	02/07/26	Flap Door Assembly (Modified) for BOXN Wagon.	20000 Nos.	14,98,790/-
14	38263884	01/07/26	Hand Brake Cable for KNORR BREMSE Design BMBS.	3540 Nos.	3,92,660/-
15	38264042A	01/07/26	Set of Nested Snubber spring Outer & Inner for LWLH 25T Bogie.	1153 Set.	1,18,370/-
16	38264045	06/07/26	Low torque grease seal for upgraded class "E" (6"x11") CTRB.	120000 Nos.	12,99,890/-
17	38263903	06/07/26	Adapter (Narrow Jaw), Class "E", (6" x 11").	102815 Nos.	20,00,000/-
18	38261517	10/07/26	Side frame Key for cartridge roller bearing (for Narrow Jaw & Wide Jaw).	307662 Nos.	8,09,590/-
19	38261524	10/07/26	Constant Contact Polyurethane Side Bearer Assembly (Design-B).	3030 Nos.	6,46,720/-
20	38261564	10/07/26	Modified Elastomeric Pad, Design-A for CASNUB Bogie.	156900 Nos.	20,00,000/-
21	GEM/2026/B/7518934	01/06/26	Supply and Installation of different types of Furniture etc.	01 Set.	2,57,000/-
22	33263239	10/08/26	Emergency Lighting System for EOC type etc.	1870 Nos.	214040/-
23	33263254	07/07/26	High Capacity Inter Vehicle Coupler etc.	350 Nos.	1672230/-
24	33261513A	22/06/26	Bogie Frame Assembly for Coil Spring etc.	27 Nos.	188620/-
25	31261481	22/06/26	NON-ASBESTOS BASED "K" TYPE HIGH FRICTION etc.	94885 Nos.	716580/-
26	30261428	20/07/26	Water Tank Assembly (455 litres) etc.	390 Nos.	361720/-
27	30261434	13/07/26	Kit for Brake gear Bushes for BMBC coach etc.	770 Set.	155370/-
28	33263222	29/05/26	Set of Bite type Fittings for LHB coaches etc.	260 Set.	242070/-
Interested tenderers may visit website www.ireps.gov.in for full Details/Description/ Specification of the tenders and submit their Bids online. In no case manual tenders for these items will be accepted. N.B: Prospective Bidders may regularly visit www.ireps.gov.in to participate in all other tenders & any Corrigendum published thereafter.					
(PR- 220)					

GOVT. OF JHARKHAND
CABINET SECRETARIAT AND VIGILANCE DEPARTMENT (CIVIL AVIATION DIVISION)
STATE HANGAR, BIRSA MUNDA AIRPORT ROAD, HINOO, RANCHI-834002
Email: dir_ops@jharkhandaviation.in; govtflyops@gmail.com
Telefax: 0651-2250319, 2251090
e-Tender Ref N o.: XI/Special Tenders/01/2026-ᱡᱷᱟᱨᱠᱷᱚᱸᱰᱤ / 370, / Ranchi /Dated:21.05.2026
e-TENDER NOTICE
Offers under **TWO BID SYSTEM** are hereby invited by Civil Aviation Division (CAD), Govt. of Jharkhand from OEM/OEM Authorized Representative/OEM Authorized Vendor / Agency involved in the aircraft spare parts supply business for procurement and supply of Aircraft Spare Tools/Equipment, spares etc. on requirement basis for the type of Aircraft in use according to selected quoted price (No consortium bid will be entertained).
1. Bidder has to deposit Rs. 1,00,000/- (One Lakh Rupees) EMD through online mode. Other terms and conditions and technical parameters are specified in the Detailed Tender Document.
2. Tender Document can be downloaded from the website www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in. The bidders have to submit their bids online through e-tendering mode only at www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in.
3. Last date and time of submission of bid online at www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in will be as per the Schedule of Events mentioned in the Tender Document.
a) e-Tenders will be opened in the office chamber of The Director (Ops), CAD, State Hangar, B M Airport, Hinoo, Ranchi by a committee duly constituted by CAD. If intervened by a holiday, bids will be received /opened at the same time on next working day.
b) The Technical Bids shall be opened first for scrutiny of the bid documents and technical data etc. The schedule of events for different activities is given below:

Scheduled of Events	
Detail of Events	Date
1. Publish of Tender on website & Start of Downloading Tender Documents	21/05/2026, 06:00 P.M.
2. Pre Bid Meeting	25/05/2026, 04:00 P.M.
3. Start of Submission of e-bids	26/05/2026, 04:00 P.M.
4. Last date for submission of e-bids.	06/06/2026, 04:00 P.M.
5. Opening of Technical Bids.	08/06/2026, 04:00 P.M.
6. Opening of Financial Bids.	After scrutiny of the Technical Bid
7. Award of agreement	Shall be notified later.

NOTE: If Technical Bid of any bidder is found incomplete, not supported by requisite EMD and /or required documents or deficient of any technical parameters as specified in the Detailed Tender Document, their Financial Bid shall not be opened.
4. Bidders are requested to check www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in a regular basis for updates.
5. CAD, Govt. of Jharkhand reserves the right to cancel or modify any of the above conditions or cancel any or all tender terms without assigning any reason.
Sd/-
Capt. S. P. Sinha
Director (Ops) Civil Aviation Division
PR 380664 Civil Aviation (26-27)JD

OBITUARY & REMEMBRANCE

DEATH

Shri K R Kunchithapatham
(The Commonwealth Sales Corporation
Labella Instrumentina
Arul Sakthi & Co.
Kaliswari Fireworks)
(13.06.1934 - 25.05.2026)
(H/O Sundari K)
Breathed his last very peacefully and attained Sivakoti Prapthi
Last Rites: May 26, 2026 from residence (New No.32, Ramanathan St, T.Nagar, Chennai-17).
Cremation at Guindy.
Deeply mourned by
Ramesh K | Subashini R | Neela S
Jaishankar K | Reshma J | Vasanthy R
Srivatsan S | Aiyawasya R
Sushita J | Samith J | Avinita S
& the entire family
PH: 9840446759/8754472774

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

14th ANNIVERSARY

OBITUARY

Dr. Aruna Sivakami Ananthakrishnan
24.05.1947 to 24.05.2026
Former Vice Chancellor
Mother Teresa Women's University, Kodalkanal
Former Head,
Department of Politics and Public Administration ,
University of Madras, Chennai-5
Deeply Mourned by
Son Ramakrishna
Daughter Prasanna Sriya
Grandson Vikas Madhav

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

Twelfth Anniversary
P.B.SRINIVASAN
Madras Telephones (Retd.).
D.O.D: 26.5.2014
Remembered by
Wife, Daughters,
Son, Daughter-in-law,
& Grandchildren
96772 64455
94452 22442

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

Oh, Veena, We Miss You - Family Members

Date of Birth
21.04.1962
Date of Demise
26.05.2012

OBITUARY

Kizhakkekalam Jayalakshmi (86),
wife of late Gopi Nair
passed away on 25.05.2026 at her son's residence in Anna Nagar, Chennai.
Fondly remembered by:
K Madhavan, Beena Pradeep, and G Ramdas.

OBITUARY

S. Balasubramanian
Retd. Provident Fund Commissioner
Passed away on 25/05/2026
Deeply mourned by Family & Friends
Ct: 97031 78612

FIRST YEAR REMEMBRANCE

Amma, on your first remembrance day, we cherish the memory of a kind and compassionate soul who treated everyone with love and equality.
Your countless contributions, selfless deeds, and unwavering support touched and uplifted the lives of many, while your gentle presence continues to remain a beacon of hope and inspiration to all who knew you. We miss you!
K ALAMMAL
W/o V. Jayaraman (late)
(Retd.) Sub. Post Master,
Ripon Buildings S.O,
India Post, Chennai.
10 February 1948 - 26 May 2025
Siva, Anitha, Alankrithi, Kumaran Niranjana, Family and Friends.

NORTH WESTERN RAILWAY
E-Tender Notice
Dy.CEE(W), NWR, Ajmer on behalf of The President of India invites E-Tender for the following work up to 15.00 Hrs. on the mention date. Tender No.: **EL/50/25/2025-26RT**. Name of work: Repair, Servicing and overhauling of Cummins make Diesel Alternator Set 500KVA, 750V in Power Cars during POH at carriage workshop Ajmer. Approximate cost: Rs. 270476613.19/-, Earnest money: Rs. 5409500/-, Date & Time of closing of E-Tender: 05.06.2026 at 15.00 Hrs. Date & Time of opening of E-Tender: 05.06.2026 at 15.30 Hrs. The details of above E-Tender is available on website www.ireps.gov.in. 772-MG/26
Follow us on: [Facebook](https://www.facebook.com/NWRRailways) [Instagram](https://www.instagram.com/NWRRailways) [YouTube](https://www.youtube.com/NWRRailways) [WhatsApp](https://www.whatsapp.com/NWRRailways)

INBRIEF



Fire at hill near Naidu's camp office brought under control

A forest fire that broke out in the hilly terrain of Undavalli in Amaravati in Guntur district of Andhra Pradesh on Sunday night was brought completely under control, with officials urging local residents not to panic as precautionary measures remain in place. This area is close to the camp office of Chief Minister N. Chandrababu Naidu. The fire and emergency personnel rushed to the spot with fire engines immediately after receiving information about the incident.

Leopard cub rescued at veterinary varsity in Tirupati

A nearly one-year-old female leopard was rescued from a toilet at S.V. Veterinary University (SVVU) Clinical Complex on Monday morning. It was then shifted to the Animal Rescue Centre at S.V. Zoological Park in Tirupati for observation and further care. "All protocols have been followed to ensure the safety of the animal and the personnel involved. The animal is being closely monitored by the veterinary team," S.V. Zoological Park Curator Anurag Meena said.

Doctor does surgery from Wuhan on Hyderabad patient

Dr. Syed Mohammed Ghouse, robotic surgeon at the Asian Institute of Nephrology and Urology (AINU) in Hyderabad, remotely performed a robotic ureteric reimplant procedure on May 18, on a Hyderabad patient diagnosed with lower ureteric stricture while he was physically present at Tongji Hospital in Wuhan, China. The patient was prepared for the surgery by the team in Hyderabad, then Dr. Ghouse took over and controlled the robotic system in real time.

Waqf Board complicating Munambam issue: Kerala CM

Waqf Board chairman says board complied with Centre's directive; V.D. Satheesan promises protection for the affected families of Munambam and says not a single resident would be evicted

The Hindu Bureau
KOTTAYAM

Chief Minister V.D. Satheesan on Monday accused the Kerala State Waqf Board, constituted during the previous government's tenure, of "deliberately trying to complicate and derail attempts" by the United Democratic Front (UDF) administration to resolve the Munambam land issue swiftly in Ernakulam district of Kerala.

His response follows the Waqf Board's action of completing the registration of the controversial land on the Unified Waqf Management, Empower-



Residents of Munambam in Kerala's Ernakulam forming a human chain demanding revenue rights for their land holdings. H. VIBHU

ment, Efficiency and Development (UMEED) portal. "Ordinarily, it is the Muthavalli who is required to register the Waqf property on the UMEED portal. But in this case, the Waqf Board itself has taken

the initiative. What we can understand from this is it is a deliberate attempt to pit two communities against each other," the Chief Minister said. He promised that "not a single resident" would be evicted from Mu-

nambam and promised complete protection for the affected families, while also facilitating the payment of land tax by them.

Waqf Board chairman K.S. Hamsa hit back sharply, insisting that the board had merely complied with the directions issued by the Centre. "The board holds the authorities of Farook College responsible for misleading them and illegally selling the property. It is the duty of the Waqf Board to ensure that every property is registered. Since the Muthavalli of Farook College was not expected to register the land, we took the initiative ourselves," he explained.

'Needless fuss': Satheesan defends posting former Kerala poll officer as his Secretary

The Hindu Bureau
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

Kerala Chief Minister V.D. Satheesan has said that "a needless fuss" is being made over the decision to appoint Indian Administrative Service officer Rathan U. Kelkar, till recently Chief Electoral Officer of the State, as his Secretary.

Briefing presspersons in Thiruvananthapuram on Monday on the decisions taken by the Cabinet, Mr. Satheesan said neither the Communist Party of India

(Marxist), which was in power then, nor the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP), had found fault with Mr. Kelkar's service as CEO. The only complaints were made from his own office as the then Leader of the Opposition. And even those were not targeted at Mr. Kelkar at a personal level, he said.

Moreover, the appointment cannot be equated with the appointments in West Bengal where the Trinamool Congress, the Congress and the CPI(M) had

levelled serious charges against the CEO after the large-scale elimination of names from the electoral rolls during the Special Intensive Revision, Mr. Satheesan said.

In Kerala, no such complaints were levelled against the CEO by the Opposition, which at the time, was the Congress-led United Democratic Front (UDF).

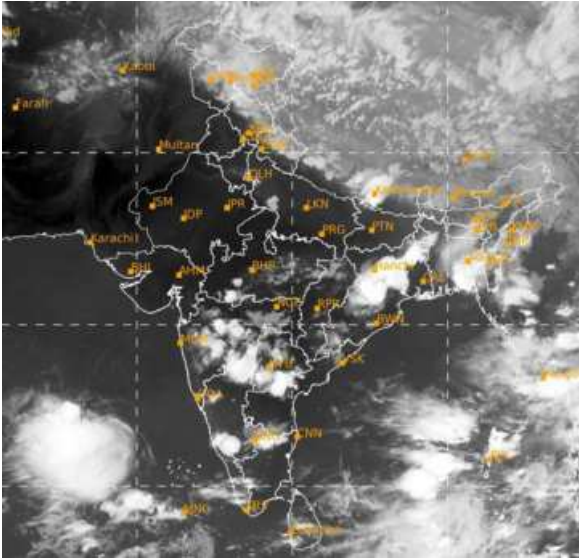
"What exactly is the basis of this controversy? He (Mr. Kelkar) is an All India Service officer posted in

Kerala. The Election Commission of India selects an officer from the panel submitted by the State government to be appointed CEO for conducting the election. After the election, does the official life of the officer come to an end?" Mr. Satheesan asked.

Mr. Kelkar is "an efficient officer with a good track record" in departments, including Information Technology, Environment, Planning and Economic Affairs and Taxes, the Chief Minister said.

WEATHERWATCH

Rainfall, temperature & air quality in select metros yesterday



TEMPERATURE DATA: IMD, POLLUTION DATA: CPCB, MAP: INSAT/IMD (TAKEN AT 18.15 HRS)

Forecast for Tuesday: Heavy/very heavy rainfall likely at isolated places over Assam, Meghalaya, Manipur, Mizoram, Tripura, Sikkim, Tamil Nadu, Puducherry, Karaikal, Kerala and Mahe. Heat wave to severe heat wave conditions likely at isolated places over Rajasthan, Punjab, Chandigarh, Delhi, Uttar Pradesh and Madhya Pradesh

CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN	CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN
Agartala	36	31.6	23.0	Kozhikode	0.3	34.8	26.2
Ahmedabad	43.0	28.4		Kurnool	27	39.4	23.3
Aizawl	7.4	32.4	21.2	Lucknow	42.3	26.6	
Allahabad	45.4	29.0		Madurai	37.8	26.7	
Bengaluru	34.0	20.8		Mangaluru	32.1	24.1	
Bhopal	43.4	29.6		Mumbai	35.1	29.4	
Bhubaneswar	38.3	29.1		Mysuru	32.8	21.0	
Chandigarh	42.4	26.6		New Delhi	43.5	32.4	
Chennai	41.3	30.3		Patna	38.2	28.2	
Coimbatore	11	34.0	20.8	Port Blair	12	31.5	26.0
Dehradun	40.4	24.6		Puducherry	37.3	22.4	
Gangtok	39	22.2	15.1	Pune	37.0	24.2	
Goa	7	33.6	25.8	Raipur	45.1	30.0	
Guwahati	7	29.0	22.6	Ranchi	39.8	26.0	
Hubballi	33.0	24.0		Shillong	3	23.0	16.5
Hyderabad	42.2	29.7		Shimla	33.0	22.0	
Imphal	2	30.5	20.5	Srinagar	1	23.3	13.0
Jaipur	2	43.6	30.4	Thiruvananthapuram	2	31.9	25.0
Kochi	64	29.6	25.0	Tiruchi	1	37.3	24.6
Kohima	25.0	17.0		Vijayawada	45.0	31.5	
Kolkata	36.5	30.1		Visakhapatnam	36.0	30.2	

(Rainfall data in mm; temperature in Celsius)

Pollutants in the air you are breathing

CITIES	SO ₂	NO ₂	CO	PM _{2.5}	PM ₁₀	CODE	Yesterday
Ahmedabad	5	10	38	43	103		In observation made at 4.00 p.m., Charkhi Dadri, Haryana recorded an overall air quality index (AQI) score of 392 indicating an unhealthy level of pollution. In contrast, Thiruvananthapuram, Kerala recorded a healthy AQI score of 17
Bengaluru	5	24	52	58	114		
Chennai	6	14	30	46	62		
Delhi	21	77	27	214	366		
Hyderabad	16	15	34	61	92		
Kolkata	8	23	22	66	102		
Lucknow	9	46	49	147	117		
Mumbai	53	43	15	41	50		
Pune	32	100	17	44	44		
Visakhapatnam	10	25	13	40	118		

Air Quality Code: Poor Moderate Good (Readings indicate average AQI)
SO₂: Sulphur Dioxide. Short-term exposure can harm the respiratory system, making breathing difficult. It can affect visibility by reacting with other air particles to form haze and stain culturally important objects such as statues and monuments.

NO₂: Nitrogen Dioxide. Aggravates respiratory illness, causes haze to form by reacting with other air particles, causes acid rain, pollutes coastal waters.

CO: Carbon monoxide. High concentration in air reduces oxygen supply to critical organs like the heart and brain. At very high levels, it can cause dizziness, confusion, unconsciousness and even death.

PM_{2.5} & PM₁₀: Particulate matter pollution can cause irritation of the eyes, nose and throat, coughing, chest tightness and shortness of breath, reduced lung function, irregular heartbeat, asthma attacks, heart attacks and premature death in people with heart or lung disease

WHEN CONFLICTS
BRING UNCERTAINTY

CONVERSATIONS
BRING CLARITY

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KEY SPEAKERS



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A. Revanth Reddy
Chief Minister of
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**Dr. Thamizhachi
Thangapandian**
Member of Parliament,
Lok Sabha



Dr. K. G. Arunraj
Health Minister, Tamil Nadu,
and General Secretary
for Policy, TVK



Nirupama Rao
Former Foreign Secretary of India;
Former Ambassador
to the U.S. & China



Philip Green
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From black to grey

India needs to prepare for a future with an ageing population

If India wanted proof of its shifting demographic status, then the latest SRS bulletin, 2024 has provided just that. The figures from the Sample Registration System - Statistical Report, 2024, offer incontrovertible proof – falling fertility rate, low crude birth rate – to show that India’s pace of population growth is considerably slowing down. While the pundits predict at least three decades of population growth for the country, the plunging fertility rate certainly commands pause for contemplation and forward planning, for India to crest a crisis that several nations are struggling to manage. India’s Total Fertility Rate has dropped to 1.9, lower than the replacement level of 2.1, aided, in large, by a falling birth rate. As per the latest SRS data, India’s birth rate fell from 21 in 2014 to 18.3 in 2024; while death rate marginally went down from 6.7 to 6.4. The country is well on its way from population ‘explosion’ to one of ageing population and shrinking workforce expansion. India might still reap its demographic dividend – the median age in India is 29.2 years, in stark contrast to China (median age of 40.2), and several other European nations. In 2026, India has approximately 370 to 380 million youth, aged 15-29 years, representing roughly 27 % of the country’s population. Estimates also put India’s below 35 years population at over 65% of the total, making it one of the world’s youngest cohorts.

In demographic terms, falling birth rate reflects a decline in fertility, linked to factors such as urbanisation, better education, access to contraception, and the desire for smaller families. India’s high life expectancy at birth (72 years) and dipping death rate offer the other side of the transition paradigm, implying better access to health care. India needs to reassess the path ahead and pivot to prepare for the needs of a future greying nation, when the demographic dividend disappears. The SRS data, however, flags a more immediate concern too – one of vast regional and rural/urban disparities. Overall, performance in rural areas is not on a par with the urban centres, and the southern States continue to stay ahead of the northern States. Overall, child survival improvements are real (the Infant Mortality Rate has fallen to 24) but high-burden States in the north are still at a much higher IMR. States and areas that lag will need targeted interventions, whether it is access to health care, awareness or education facilities to effect a national convergence.

Baby bait

Incentives for having more children will keep poorer women out of workforce

Departing from decades of family-planning policies in India, the Andhra Pradesh government has proposed new incentives for families in the State to have three or more children. The State’s total fertility rate has dropped from around 3 in the 1990s to 1.5 today, well below the replacement rate of 2.1 as well as the national average. According to some projections, nearly a quarter of the State population will be elderly by the mid-century, resulting in a smaller workforce relative to the old-age dependency burden. But while South India is ageing faster than the North, the evidence for cash incentives leading to larger families and doing so without significant socio-economic trade-offs is weak. At present, Andhra Pradesh has proposed ₹30,000 for a third child and ₹40,000 for a fourth; ₹1,000 monthly for five years; free education until the age of 18; provisions for mothers to work from home; enhanced funding for the ‘Thaliki Vandanam’ scheme, which currently pays ₹15,000 per child for school attendance; longer maternity leave; and other Anganwadi and childcare support. While one-time payments may encourage some families to have children earlier than planned, evidence from India and around the world indicates that they rarely produce large or sustained increases in fertility.

People in the State are having fewer children likely because housing and private education have become more expensive, stable employment is accessible later rather than sooner, and aspirations around children’s quality of life have expanded. The proposed incentives are unlikely to offset the 18-year cost of raising one additional child even under optimistic assumptions about public provisions. The State government has also said that it wants to double women’s labour force participation, which is antithetical to having more children with the existing social infrastructure. Indeed, France and the Nordic states were able to maintain this two-pronged success only by investing heavily in universal childcare, flexible working arrangements, paid parental leave, high-quality public schooling, and legal protections against career penalties that mothers are at risk of. Otherwise, as is already prevalent in India, mothers end up absorbing more unpaid care work and cannot enter the workforce. Crucially, the economics of the proposed incentives are more likely to influence poorer households seeking immediate cash, leading to an uncomfortable possibility: the State modestly increasing the size of economically vulnerable families without guaranteeing adequate long-term support for child development. Finally, ecological concerns such as water scarcity, urban congestion, waste management, and recycling will also be tested in the long term. While the southern States are anxious about population-based delimitation, asking families to alter personal decisions about having children to address a problem of constitutional design would be a profound mismatch between instrument and objective.

The Finance Commission (FC), constituted under the Constitution, determines the distribution of the Union’s gross tax revenues between Centre and States and among the States themselves to address vertical and horizontal fiscal imbalances. Following earlier commissions, the 16th FC has retained the vertical devolution share of 41% for the States and continued to emphasise equity as the guiding principle in determining horizontal transfers.

During consultations with the FC, States raised several concerns regarding the structure of fiscal transfers. Since cesses and surcharges exceeded 15% of gross tax revenues, they should either be included in the divisible pool or capped at around 8%-10%. In addition, the Centre receives substantial non-tax revenues from natural resource extraction, asset monetisation and surplus transfers from the Reserve Bank of India.

States and pressures

States also face mounting fiscal pressures. The COVID-19 pandemic, structural changes introduced by the Goods and Services Tax (and recent rate rationalisation from four rates to two principal rates), and mounting public debt further constrained their fiscal space. Moreover, the growing dominance of Centrally Sponsored Schemes has narrowed their fiscal autonomy (the restructuring of the National Rural Employment Guarantee programme requires States to bear 40% of programme costs), while buoyancy of central taxes has slowed. These factors could reduce the actual transfers to States, leading several States to demand a 50% vertical share.

Another concern is frequent changes in devolution criteria and their assigned weights across successive FCs in order to transfer more resources to fiscally weaker States, making it difficult for States to predict their future shares. Many States called for a reduced weight for the income-distance criterion and suggested adjusting it for purchasing-power differences to better reflect variations in the cost of living.

Over time, the shares of better-performing States have steadily declined compared with those of major beneficiary States. The combined shares of four major beneficiary States – Bihar (including Jharkhand), Madhya Pradesh (including Chhattisgarh), Uttar Pradesh (including Uttarakhand) and West Bengal – increased from 42.5% during the Sixth FC period to 51% under the 15th FC. In contrast, the combined share of the four southern States – Andhra Pradesh (including Telangana), Karnataka, Kerala and Tamil Nadu – declined from 24.8% to 15.8%, widening the gap to 35.2%. Continued reliance on unconditional equalisation transfers may weaken incentives for revenue mobilisation and fiscal discipline in weaker States. Moreover, rising



K.R. Shanmugam

Former Director, Madras School of Economics, and Consultant to the Government of Tamil Nadu

Under the 16th Finance Commission, arbitrary weights affect better-performing States

transfers to poorer States have not eliminated disparities in public expenditure even on basic services. In 2022-23, Bihar spent ₹937 per person on health, against Arunachal Pradesh’s ₹10,148 (10.8 times lower), while Bihar’s per-student spending on elementary education in 2023-24 was ₹20,282 compared with Sikkim’s ₹1,30,498. These gaps show that fiscal transfers alone have not ensured convergence in public service delivery.

Recommendations of Finance Commission

The 16th FC accepted the Centre’s argument that cesses and surcharges cannot be shared because they often finance welfare and infrastructure programmes that indirectly benefit States and retained 41% vertical share. It also abolished revenue-deficit grants as well as sector-specific and State-specific grants and recommended that States discontinue off-budget borrowings, bring all liabilities onto their budgets and maintain fiscal deficits below 3%. These measures could increase short-term fiscal stress for States.

The FC made only modest adjustments to the criteria used by the 15th FC. Income distance received a weight of 42.5%; population 17.5%; area 10%; forest cover 10%; and the demographic criterion – modified by replacing the inverse fertility rate with population growth – 10%. It also introduced States’ contribution to national GDP, replacing tax effort, with a 10% weight. However, instead of using actual GSDP shares, the FC applied a square-root transformation to State GSDP shares, with a weight of just 10%, far below the expected 25%. This significantly reduced the advantage of economically stronger States and altered the rankings. Maharashtra’s actual GSDP share of 14.23% fell to 8.31% after the transformation, while Tamil Nadu’s declined from 9.09% to 6.67% and Karnataka’s from 8.95% to 6.59%. At the same time, the shares of many smaller States increased.

Consequently, overall devolution shares of 14 States rose marginally compared with the 15th FC. Karnataka gained the most (0.484 percentage point increase), followed by Kerala (0.457) and Gujarat (0.277). Tamil Nadu saw only a negligible rise, from 4.079% to 4.097%. Meanwhile, the shares of 14 States declined, with Madhya Pradesh experiencing the largest reduction (0.503 percentage points), followed by Arunachal Pradesh (0.403) and Uttar Pradesh (0.32).

From a longer-term perspective, however, disparities remain substantial. Under the 16th FC, the southern States’ share has risen slightly to about 17%, while the share of the largest beneficiary States has fallen to just under 50% – a shift of only about 1.2% in favour of the southern States. The balance between equity and efficiency has changed only marginally. Under the 15th FC, efficiency-related criteria accounted for 25% of

the weight and equity criteria for 75%; under the 16th FC, this has shifted to 30% and 70%, respectively – an adjustment too small to significantly alter outcomes. Poorer States such as Uttar Pradesh (17.62%), Bihar (9.95%), Madhya Pradesh (7.35%) and West Bengal (7.22%) continue to receive larger shares than fiscally stronger and better-performing States.

Devolutions with alternative schemes

Alternative weighting schemes suggest that the outcomes could have been different. If the FC had assigned a 25% weight to the square root of GDP contribution while reducing the weight of income distance to 27.5%, Karnataka’s share would have increased from 4.131% to 4.928%, Maharashtra’s from 6.441% to 7.218%, and Tamil Nadu’s from 4.097% to 4.867%. Under an equal-weight scheme across the six criteria, their shares would have risen further to 5.544%, 7.845%, and 5.246%, respectively.

Had the FC used actual GSDP share (instead of square root formula) with 10% weight, the devolution shares of Maharashtra, Karnataka and Tamil Nadu would have increased to 7.033%, 4.367% and 4.342% respectively. With 25% weight (and 27.5% weight to income distance), they would have increased to 8.698%, 5.517% and 5.478%. With equal weighting scheme, their respective shares might have increased to 8.833%, 5.937% and 5.653%. That is, their respective shares increased by 2.392%, 1.806% and 1.556%.

Given that the 16th FC estimates total vertical transfers of ₹104 lakh crore over the award period, these differences are significant. A 2.392% increase in Maharashtra’s share would translate into an additional ₹2.49 lakh crore, or about ₹49,744 crore annually. Karnataka’s additional 1.806% share would yield about ₹1.88 lakh crore, or roughly ₹37,565 crore annually. Tamil Nadu’s 1.556% increase would amount to approximately ₹1.62 lakh crore, or ₹32,365 crore annually.

In India, unlike other large federations such as Australia and China, States with greater political influence in terms of parliamentary representation are not necessarily the economically stronger ones. Consequently, these States tend to receive higher fiscal transfers. The issue is likely to intensify after delimitation, as governments may have stronger incentives to favour politically influential States. Since the FC’s primary objective is to address both vertical and horizontal fiscal imbalances, future FCs should place greater emphasis on fiscal capacity and fiscal outcome indicators rather than relying predominantly on non-fiscal indicators. Additionally, they should adopt more data-driven approaches for assigning weights, such as the principal component analysis method.

The views expressed are personal

India and Australia – bridging the trade and trust barrier

Is a comprehensive India-Australia Free Trade Agreement (FTA) in the offing? With the Australian Foreign Minister Penny Wong in India for the Quad Foreign Ministers’ meeting, there is anticipation that a Comprehensive Economic Cooperation Agreement (CECA) may be inked. This would expand the 2022 Economic Cooperation and Trade Agreement (ECTA) that had opened 100% of the Australian market to India while India reciprocated with roughly 70% market access covering nearly 91% of trade value. Canberra has since been pushing for parity, both privately and publicly. Meanwhile the West Asia crisis has forced upon India – in the words of the Chief Economic Adviser – a “balance of payments crisis stress test”, making trade expansion and courting investments an urgent necessity for the country.

India has been in a hurry over the past year to conclude trade agreements; geopolitical fragility and the unpredictability of tariff politics have pushed India to sign agreements with the EU, the U.S., New Zealand and the U.K. CECA fits neatly into this larger recalibration.

The problems with Australia

But with Australia, the trade situation is complicated. Since ECTA, bilateral merchandise trade doubled from \$12.2 billion in FY 2020-21 to \$24.1 billion in FY 2024-25. These gains, however, have not been evenly shared. Australian exports to India account for nearly two-thirds of the bilateral trade.

Even in services, where bilateral trade has crossed \$10 billion, Australia’s higher education sector alone accounts for close to 60%. In contrast, investment tells the opposite story: as of 2024, Indian investment in Australia had touched nearly \$32 billion against Australia’s cumulative FDI into India of about \$18 billion.

The bilateral relationship is thus beset by interconnected problems. Australia wants parity in market access. But the question for India is not whether India should simply concede more market access; it is whether India can trade some market access for a more balanced overall



Vaibhav Jain

Incoming delegate of the Australia-India Youth Dialogue



Raja Karthikeya

Former delegate of the Australia-India Youth Dialogue

An India-Australia trade deal must prioritise balance over parity

relationship. Australia’s 2025 Economic Engagement Roadmap for India identified four bilateral ‘superhighways’: clean energy, education, tourism, and agribusiness. On the first three, there appears to be broad alignment but not on the fourth. Agriculture is where this bargain becomes most difficult. India has restricted access to its agricultural market in nearly all its major trade agreements. Despite being compelled to keep India’s most vulnerable sectors (dairy, wheat, rice, sugar and chickpeas) outside ECTA, Australian farm exports to India have risen by nearly 90%, while Indian agricultural exports to Australia have grown more modestly by 35%.

This asymmetry reflects two very different agricultural realities. The average Indian farm is about 0.73 hectares; the average Australian farm exceeds 1,400 hectares. Agriculture contributes around 16% to India’s GDP and 2.5% to Australia’s. For Australia, agriculture is an export industry. For India, it is a livelihood that supports more than half of its population and remains the bedrock of its food security.

The notion of a “level playing field” between these two systems is hence a misframing of the problem. Indian farmers, even with subsidised inputs, remain structurally exposed to monsoon variability, fragmented landholdings and thin margins. Protecting the Indian market from cheap Australian imports, particularly wheat, is not a negotiating position; it is a political necessity. Yet, given the industrial scale of Australia’s farming, Canberra will understandably push India to open up its market fully.

Using agriculture as an opportunity

Nonetheless, agricultural trade talks between the two countries need not become a zero-sum game. Agriculture can become the sector through which India converts Australia’s demand for market access into a broader opportunity for institutional cooperation and investment. Two low-hanging fruits stand out.

First, the future of India-Australia agricultural trade must depend less on tariff concessions and

more on mutual recognition of biosecurity and phytosanitary standards. Building on the 2025 organic products arrangement, both countries can expand cooperation in digital certification, quarantine protocols and regulatory alignment. This would give Indian farmers a fairer shot at the Australian market even as India considers reciprocal access for Australian farmers.

Second, Australia’s strategic opportunity in India may lie beyond agricultural commodities and in exporting the systems that make modern agriculture possible: precision farming technologies, cold-chain infrastructure, water management expertise and climate adaptation practices. India loses anywhere from 15% to 35% of its agricultural output to pests, disease and post-harvest inefficiencies every year. Australia’s extensive experience in dealing with drought cycles, heat extremes and water scarcity is knowledge that would interest India.

However, this experience sharing must go hand-in-hand with real investments. Australian capital, technology and know-how must register a deeper presence inside India’s agricultural sector – in storage facilities, logistics networks, farm-level tools and agri-technology partnerships between firms, universities and local governments. The recently launched India-Australia Smart Farm Network Initiative points in the right direction.

Need for complementarity

Agriculture is too politically important in India to be treated as just another line item in a trade schedule; equally, it is too economically important to be left outside the bilateral partnership altogether. Rather than making the new FTA one of absolute symmetry in market access alone, India and Australia should make it an agreement based on complementarity across trade and investment.

Should the diplomats succeed, the day when Chyawanprash and Vegemite sit on the same breakfast table in the two countries is not far.

The views expressed are personal

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Ties bound by respect

India and the United States share strong diplomatic and economic ties, but recent incidents expose double standards and disrespect towards India. While Indian professionals contribute immensely to the U.S. economy, cases of racial remarks, humiliating visa

procedures and unfair treatment of Indian students continue to surface. At the same time, America expects India to support its strategic interests and trade priorities. True friendship between nations must be based on mutual respect, not

superiority. The U.S. should understand that today’s India is a rising global power with talent, technology and economic strength.

T. Kailash Ditya, Hyderabad

Missing children

May 25 was “International

Missing Children’s Day”, yet there was not a word about it on most platforms. Greater awareness is

needed about this grave and sensitive issue, especially when thousands of children go missing

Corrections & Clarifications

The Data Point, “Now, only two young States haven’t had a coalition govt.” (Opinion Piece, May 25, 2026), incorrectly marked Kerala, in Chart 1 for 2004, as having a “single-party” government.

The Readers’ Editor’s office can be contacted by Telephone: +91-44-28576347/28576300; E-mail: readerseditor@thehindu.co.in

around the world.

Sreelekha P.S., Secunderabad



More letters online. Letters emailed to letters@thehindu.co.in must carry the postal address.

A definite end to the Silverline

 A CH-CHE

BJP hits out at Congress over fuel price hike comments

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Bharatiya Janata Party on Monday criticised Rahul Gandhi, the Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha, for his remarks on fuel price hikes.

BJP national spokesperson Gaurav Bhatia said that under Prime Minister Narendra Modi's leadership, India had been confronting the challenges arising from the West Asia crisis with strength. Referring to the remarks of Mr. Gandhi and Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge on the latest increase in prices of petrol and diesel, Mr. Bhatia asked: "In a global challenge, whether one belongs to the ruling party or Opposition, can they not stand with the country?"

He said for nearly 65 to 70 days of the West Asia war, fuel prices in India remained unchanged as the intention was to ensure that common citizen did not suffer. "Oil companies absorbed losses because they did not want the public to suffer. While there is a gas crisis globally, domestic gas remains available in India because it is our priority," said Mr. Bhatia.

He alleged that after the war began, instead of supporting the Prime Minister's appeal to citizens, the Congress "spread panic" through misinformation. He said every decision taken related to fuel prices would be in public interest.

'Daily robbery': Opposition slams fresh fuel price hike

Kharge says every hike is a blow to household budgets; Rahul terms Modi 'inflation man'; says fuel prices were being increased in 'instalments', Kejriwal asks why cheaper oil was not being sourced

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

As petrol and diesel prices were raised by ₹2.61-₹2.71 a litre on Monday, marking the fourth increase in less than two weeks, the Opposition leaders stepped up their attack on the Narendra Modi government, accusing it of burdening consumers and failing to shield them from rising costs.

While Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge described the increase as "daily robbery", Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi called Prime Minister Narendra Modi "mehangai manav" (inflation man). Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) convener Arvind Kejriwal questioned why India was not sourcing cheaper crude oil from Russia and Iran.

In a post on social media platform X, Mr. Kharge said the "daily assault of fuel loot" was continuing, noting that this was the fourth hike in 10 days. "The Modi government has sprinkled petrol to burn the savings of common people," the Congress chief said.

Mr. Kharge alleged that despite international crude oil prices not witnessing an increase comparable to that seen during the United Progressive Alliance (UPA)



Running on fumes: Motorists at a petrol pump in New Delhi on Monday. Petrol and diesel prices were raised for the fourth time in less than two weeks. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

years, retail fuel prices had risen sharply under the BJP government. He claimed that petrol prices had increased from ₹71.41 a litre in 2014 to ₹102.12 in 2026, while diesel prices had risen from ₹56.71 to ₹95.20 during the same period.

The Congress president also linked Monday's hike to gains in shares of public sector oil companies and alleged that the government prioritised "profit over people".

'Who is benefitting'

"Every fuel price hike is another blow to household budgets," he said, adding that farmers and micro, small, and medium enterprises were among those

most affected. "We repeat. Who is benefitting from this daily robbery?" he asked.

Mr. Gandhi also attacked the Prime Minister, alleging that fuel prices were being increased in "instalments". "Mehangai manav" Modi strikes again. He raises petrol and diesel prices in instalments – ensuring that your pockets are quietly picked, bit by bit," he said in a post on X.

Mr. Gandhi claimed that he had warned of an impending economic storm, but the government had delayed the increases because of elections. "Mehangai manav" Modi has just one job: promises during elections, and attack-

ing people's pockets at other times," he said.

Mr. Kejriwal said rising inflation was imposing hardship on "140 crore people" and asked what compulsion prevented the government from purchasing cheaper fuel. "Russia and Iran are offering us cheaper and sufficient oil and gas. Why is Prime Minister Narendra Modi not buying cheap oil from them?" he asked in a video message on X.

Congress spokesperson Ragini Nayak raised concerns over oil supply disruptions and the economy. She asked what the government had done to bring back ships stranded in the Strait of Hormuz.

India-China ties, global diplomacy in spotlight at The Hindu Huddle, 2026

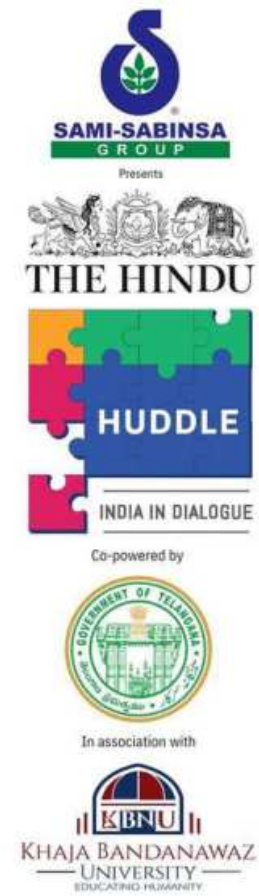
The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Geopolitical issues, particularly the unpredictable behaviour of global superpowers, will be at the core of discussions at The Hindu Huddle, as diplomats and thinkers discuss possible solutions to recent disruptions and conflicts in West Asia and Europe. The theme of the The Hindu Huddle, to be held in Bengaluru on June 5 and 6, is "A World in Transition".

Among the key speakers will be the Chinese Ambassador to India, Xu Feihong, who will discuss developments in India-China ties and the role the two countries can play on the multi-lateral stage. This will be a special session that looks at 75 years of the bilateral relationship, and particularly the last few years, with New Delhi and Beijing resuming normal diplomatic, business, and travel ties after years of freeze and military stand-off following the Galwan incident in 2020.

This year, both sides are expected to engage more closely as India chairs the BRICS Summit in September, and high-level engagements are expected to continue between them.

Another important panel on global diplomacy will focus on "The Middle Power Way". It will look at whether the international



must act together, because if we are not at the table, we're on the menu," Mr. Carney said.

The panel will have some of the most senior diplomats serving in India: Australian High Commissioner Philip Green, European Union Ambassador Herve Delphin, and Brazilian Ambassador Kenneth Felix Hascynski da Nobrega. Joining them in the discussion will be the author of *The Fractured Himalaya*, Nirupama Menon Rao, who is a former Foreign Secretary and former Ambassador to the U.S. and China.

Both discussions will be moderated by *The Hindu's* Diplomatic Affairs Editor, Suhasini Haidar.

Event partners

The event is presented by Sami-Sabinsa Group as the Presenting Partner. The event is co-powered by the Government of Telangana and held in Association with Khaja Bandanawaz University. The event is further supported by: Larsen & Toubro, Apollo Hospitals, IIM Sirmour, ICAFI Group, TAFE, Wizzmonni, Associate Partners; Casagrand, Realty Partner; Amity University Bengaluru, University Partner; Harrow International School Bengaluru, Education Partner; Meghalaya Tourism, State Partner; and NDTV 24x7, TV Partner.

President confers Padma awards; Dharmendra, N. Rajam honoured

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

President Droupadi Murmu on Monday presented Padma Vibhushan, Padma Bhushan, and Padma Shri awards for 2026 at the Civil Investiture Ceremony-I held at the Rashtrapati Bhavan here.

Among the dignitaries present on the occasion were Vice-President C. P. Radhakrishnan, Prime Minister Narendra Modi, and Union Home Minister Amit Shah.

For this year, the President has approved 131 Padma awards, including five Padma Vibhushan, 13 Padma Bhushan, and 113 Padma Shri.

They are announced ev-

ery year on Republic Day. On Monday, the President presented two Padma Vibhushan, six Padma Bhushan, and 58 Padma Shri awards.

She conferred the Padma Vibhushan on legendary Bollywood actor Dharmendra posthumously, received by his wife and MP Hema Malini; and violin virtuoso N. Rajam, for exceptional contribution to their respective fields.

'Singing violin'

Ms. Rajam pioneered a revolutionary approach to classical music by introducing "Gayaki Ang" – a technique that enables violin to emulate human vocals – earning her global renown as the "Singing



High honour: President Droupadi Murmu conferring the Padma Vibhushan on violinist N. Rajam, the Padma Bhushan on Kotak Mahindra Bank founder Uday Suresh Kumar Kotak, and the Padma Shri on cricket player Harmanpreet Kaur Bhullar in New Delhi on Monday. PTI

Violin". The Padma Bhushan was presented to former Uttarakhand Chief Minister Bhagat Singh Koshyari; Shatavadhani R.

Ganesh, who revived the classical art form of "Avadhana"; Uday Suresh Kumar Kotak, founder of Kotak Mahindra Bank; and emi-

nent gastroenterologist Kallipatti Ramasamy Palaniswamy.

The award was conferred posthumously on

former MP Vijay Kumar Malhotra and "ad guru" Pi-yush Pandey.

The remaining Padma awardees will be felicitated

in the second round of the ceremony to be held later.

Among the Padma Shri recipients were Prosenjit Chatterjee, one of the most influential figures of Indian cinema; Harmanpreet Kaur Bhullar, an inspirational figure in Indian women's cricket; para athlete Praveen Kumar; former Central Reserve Police Force (CRPF) Director-General K. Vijay Kumar; folk musician Mir Haji Kasam; Tamil devotional music artist N. Swaminathan; and traditional folk music artist Taga Ram Bheel.

Other awardees

While Silambam master K. Pajanivel was awarded for promoting the ancient art

originating from Tamil Nadu, hockey coach Baldev Singh was felicitated for distinguished service to Indian hockey for over four decades.

"Kantha" embroidery artist Tripti Mukherjee, social worker Janardan Bapurao Bothe, and husband-wife duo of Dr. Ramchandra Godbole and Suneeta Godbole, who provided healthcare and social support to tribal communities, also received the Padma Shri. Environmentalists Devaki Amma G. and Hally War; bibliophile Ankegowda M.; Sanskrit scholar Vempaty Kutumba Shastri; and botanist Gambir Singh Yonzon were the others who received the Padma Shri.

Cockroach Janta Party has not dimmed PM's popularity among youth: Haryana CM

Nistula Hebbar
NEW DELHI

Dismissing the suggestion that the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) reflected anger among the youth, Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Monday said the youth would still back Prime Minister Narendra Modi, who would be the face of the Bharatiya Janata Party in the Punjab Assembly election, slated for early next year.

Speaking during an interaction organised by the Women Journalist Welfare Trust here, Mr. Saini said the CJP did not reflect the views of the majority of the youth in the country.

"In my frequent interactions with young people, I have not seen any support for this CJP. What is the longevity of a cockroach? The Opposition, including the Congress and the Aam

Modi will be the face of the BJP in the Punjab Assembly election, says Nayab Singh Saini

Aadmi Party, have a history of concocting fake narratives, just like the Congress did during the 2024 [Lok Sabha] election, stating that the Constitution was in danger. It was the Congress that put the Constitution in danger by imposing Emergency, [and] by undertaking self-serving amendments to the Constitution," Mr. Saini said.

Visits to Punjab

Mr. Saini's reference to the AAP was noteworthy as he has been undertaking several trips to neighbouring Punjab for campaign events across the State. When asked about his

campaign interventions, Mr. Saini said that the people of Punjab showed great enthusiasm for the BJP, because of the welfare programmes implemented by BJP governments, when compared with the ruling AAP government which had failed to do so.

Mr. Modi would be the party's face in the Punjab election, he said. "The BJP has just won a historic victory in West Bengal. During the campaign, there was no local face projected, the people saw Prime Minister Modi and his governance record, and voted for the BJP. Similarly, in Punjab too, Mr. Modi will be the face," he said.

He has been visiting Punjab frequently since 2025, with observers saying that he was being deployed to stitch together a non-Jat Sikh coalition in the State.

No 'grave urgency' to entertain plea against Cockroach Party: CJI

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

Chief Justice of India Surya Kant on Monday asked a lawyer to not take the continued online frenzy over his reported use of the word "cockroach" in a court hearing so "sentimentally".

The Chief Justice was reacting to a lawyer, advocate N.K. Goswami, who expressed anxiety at the manner in which a courtroom observation from the Bench was being "distorted" online despite a clarification from the judge. The CJI's reported remark on "cockroaches" with reference to fake law degree holders during the hearing of a writ petition on May 15, spawned a public furore, and a viral online platform, the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP).

The Chief Justice had later clarified that he had



A petition was filed in the Supreme Court seeking a probe into the 'activities' of the party.

been misquoted, and had the greatest concern and respect for the youth.

On Monday, the Chief Justice said there was "no grave urgency" to entertain a writ petition filed by an SC lawyer seeking a probe into the "activities" of a "digital-political formation", the CJP, and the commercial exploitation, trademark appropriation, and monetised circulation of oral remarks made in court proceedings.

Arrests, mass resignations, 'bulldozer action' deepen Trinamool's crisis in Bengal

Shrabana Chatterjee
KOLKATA

Demolition notices for illegal construction of buildings continued to be issued in West Bengal. A police team visited Trinamool Congress general secretary Abhishek Banerjee's residence on Monday to collect security equipment. Kolkata Police officials described the visit as a routine exercise.

Arrests of local Trinamool leaders have also continued in the three weeks since the new government came to power.

A Trinamool party office in Konnagar area of Hooghly district was razed on Monday. The Trinamool office had been illegally constructed on government land, allegedly by local party councillor Khokon Pal, and was thus taken down by a bulldozer,



Abhishek Banerjee

official sources said.

The Kolkata Municipal Corporation had previously sent notices to several properties linked to Mr. Banerjee, seeking clarification about deviations from originally sanctioned plans.

Demolitions continue

Bulldozers were also deployed in Belegghata, Bosepukur, Tiljala, and Kasba areas of Kolkata on Sunday to demolish illegal multi-storeyed buildings alleged-

ly connected to former or current Trinamool leaders, and local strongmen associated with the party.

Many Trinamool councillors have resigned, and some councillors and panchayat pradhans have been arrested in the past few weeks, with the Trinamool further affected by the loss of local body members.

On Monday, at least 30 councillors in the Bhatpara municipality, including the chairman, handed in their resignation. A similar situation was reported from the Diamond Harbour municipality, where eight of the 16 Trinamool councillors resigned. In the Halisahar, Kanthi, North Barrackpore, and Garulia municipalities, over half the Trinamool councillors have resigned en masse in some areas. At least a dozen councillors across the State have been arrested

INBRIEF



Panel to study quantum tech's potential in financial sector

The Reserve Bank on Monday announced the setting up of an eight-member expert committee to study the potential of quantum technology in the financial sector. Quantum technology represents a paradigm shift compared with traditional systems as it leverages the principles of quantum mechanics. This enables quantum systems to address complex financial problems such as portfolio optimisation, risk assessment, and macroeconomic modelling, the RBI said.

Ashok Leyland bags order from VRL Logistics

Ashok Leyland Ltd. said it has bagged an order of 715 vehicles from VRL Logistics for an unspecified amount. The order includes AVTR 3120 haulage trucks, BOSS 1615 trucks and Oyster staff buses. While 300 trucks have already been delivered, the remaining 415 orders are scheduled for execution in the current year. “The order marks a strategic deepening of our partnership to drive higher logistics efficiency,” said Anand Sankeshwar, MD, VRL Logistics.

Dhoot Transmission to raise ₹1,400 crore via IPO

Auto components manufacturer Dhoot Transmission Ltd. is set to hit the capital market for raising a fresh issue of ₹1,400 crore, according to the prospectus. The proposed offer is a mix of fresh issue and an offer for sale. The fresh issue will consist of equity shares aggregating up to a value of ₹1,400 crore. The offer for sale will comprise up to 1.6 crore equity shares. The company proposes to use the IPO proceeds for repayment/prepayment of borrowings of ₹493.9 crore, and for investment in subsidiaries.

BP subsidiary, ONGC sign TSP agreement

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Building on enhanced output from Mumbai High from a similar pact, Oil and Natural Gas Corporation (ONGC) inked another technical services-provider (TSP) pact with BP Plc's subsidiary, BP Exploration Services India, for its Western Offshore fields.

“The TSP will review field performance and identify improvements in reservoir, facilities and wells to boost production from Western Offshore fields (excluding Mumbai High),” ONGC said.

It added the TSP indicated potential to raise crude output by 10.8% and gas output by 31.5% over the 10-year contract period.

“In terms of oil plus oil-equivalent gas, the increase works to about 24.1% (from 128.93 MMTOE to 159.96 MMTOE).

The increase is expected to be visible from fiscal year 2027 with full-scale

TSP indicated a raise in crude output by 10.8% and gas output by 31.5% over 10-year contract period

visibility expected from fiscal year 2030,” ONGC said.

BP Exploration Services India would be receiving a fixed fee for the initial two years and thereafter, a service fee premised on the revenue from the incremental production scaled after recovering incremental costs.

In January last year, ONGC inked a TSP contract with BP Exploration Alpha Ltd., another BP subsidiary, for Mumbai High - the largest oil field of the Mumbai Offshore basin.

According to ONGC, preliminary production from the initial months of the contract implementation indicated “moderation of the earlier decline trajectory and stabilisation of production.”

Cyient Semicon raises \$30 million

The Hindu Bureau
HYDERABAD

IT firm Cyient's subsidiary Cyient Semiconductors raised \$30 million via equity and debt from funds managed by EAAA India Alternatives (Edelweiss) and affiliated co-investors.

The transaction includes equity investment of about \$10 million at a post-money valuation of about \$500 million (₹4,600 crore) alongside

about \$20 million in structured debt to support long-duration growth, it said.

The funds would be deployed to advance product research and development roadmap across custom power semiconductors and custom ASSP's; building in-house semiconductor validation and testing infrastructure in India to boost development and qualification capabilities and supporting working capital needs, it said.

‘Prolonged war may shave 200 bps off corporate profitability’

The Hindu Bureau
MUMBAI

Having undertaken a stress test of 34 sectors, Crisil Ratings said that prolonged supply-chain disruptions due to the West Asia conflict could shave off corporate operating profitability by 200 basis points (bps) this fiscal from the pre-conflict expectation of 12%, with some sectors seeing a more pronounced impact.

This is assuming supply-chain disruptions lasting for 9 months this fiscal compared with 6 months in Crisil's base case), with crude prices averaging \$110 per barrel for this fiscal versus a base case assumption of \$95.

“For companies, managing costs and profitability will be a bigger challenge than achieving topline growth,” said Subodh Rai, MD, Crisil Ratings. “Of the 34 sectors stress-tested, 22 would see operating profitability being culled more than 10% due to higher inventory costs and inability to fully pass on the burden to consumers immediately,” he said.

“On the other hand, even a partial pass-through can drive up realisations, resulting in a lower impact on revenue growth for most sectors. Further, credit profiles will be cushioned by controlled gearing levels and sustained domestic demand. We foresee the credit quality of only 8 sectors, accounting for 10% of our rated corporate debt, being materially impacted,” he added.

Indian mobile market hit as global semicon industry faces ‘severe memflation’

India sees shortage of sub ₹10,000-₹15,000 phones as leading chips manufacturers divert capacities to meet humongous demand for high-bandwidth memory required to support AI infra

Mini Tejaswi
BENGALURU

The semiconductor industry globally is experiencing a severe structural ‘memflation’ (inflation caused by memory chips shortage), with skyrocketing prices leading to huge disruptions in price sensitive consumer electronics and mobile phone markets in India, said industry experts.

The key reason is that global wafer and advanced packaging capacities are increasingly being allocated toward high bandwidth memory (HBM) and AI infrastructure due to significantly higher demand and margins. A typical HBM takes 2-3x wafer capacity compared with a conventional DRAM.

This is making availability of conventional DRAM and NAND used in mainstream electronics tighter, according to India Electronics & Semiconductor Association (IESA).

Dynamic Random-Access Memory, or DRAM, is a type of computer memory used in PCs, laptops, and smartphones to temporarily store data that the processor needs to actively use. While NAND is a type of memory storage used in smartphones that retains data even without power.

Industry experts also confirmed that there is a shortage of sub ₹10,000 to



Off reach: The entry-level smartphone segment is under severe pressure due to rising memory chip costs. B. JOTHI RAMALINGAM

₹15,000 phones across the country as leading semiconductor (memory chips) manufacturers are diverting all their energies and production capacities away from standard consumer chips to meet the humongous demand for high-bandwidth memory required to support AI infrastructure.

India very vulnerable B.V. Naidu, a foundational architect in India's semiconductor and Electronics System Design and Manufacturing (ESDM) ecosystem and a former president of IESA, India is extremely vulnerable to memory chip shortage due to its heavy reliance on electronic component imports and a consumer base driven by price elasticity.

“It seems global chip makers are prioritising premium brands such as

Apple and Samsung for standard memory allocation, leaving budget brands in India and in other geographies to starve of chip/component supply. This has resulted in a short supply of economy smartphones in India. Also, I was told prices of several brands of cellphones have gone up by at least 15-20%,” Mr. Naidu said.

As per IESA, higher DRAM and NAND prices, combined with the shift to AI-enabled applications and larger storage needs, are making the sub ₹10,000 to ₹15,000 category increasingly difficult to sustain profitably.

“The market is witnessing a structural recalibration toward higher-value devices. That means, phone makers are prioritising premium phone production over entry level phones,” explained Ashok

सि.एस.आई.आर. मद्रास कॉम्प्लेक्स
CSIR MADRAS COMPLEX
सीएसआईआर रोड, सीएसआईआर परिसर, चरमणि, चेन्नै
CSIR Road, CSIR Campus, Taramani, Chennai-600113.

सुदिपत्र / CORRIGENDUM

सभी संबंधित उम्मीदवारों को सूचित किया जाता है कि प्रशासनिक कारणों से निम्नलिखित पदों के लिए भर्ती रद्द कर दी गई है:-

- कनिष्ठ सहायक (सा.) - हिन्दी (अन्ध पिछड़ा वर्ग) का 01 पद, जो सीएससी विज्ञान संख्या एससी-01/2025 दिनांक 16.04.2025 के माध्यम से विज्ञापित किया गया था और
- सुरक्षा सहायक का 01 पद, जो सीएससी विज्ञान संख्या 01/2024 दिनांक 28-01-2025 के माध्यम से विज्ञापित किया गया था।

It is hereby notified to all concerned candidates that the recruitment for the following posts have been cancelled due to administrative reasons.

- 01 post of Junior Secretariat Assistant (Gen) - Hindi (OBC), advertised vide CMC Advertisement No.MC-01/2025 dated 16.04.2025 and
- 01 post of Security Assistant, advertised vide CMC Advertisement No.01/2024 dated 28.01.2025.

अधिक जानकारी के लिए कृपया सीएसआईआर मद्रास कॉम्प्लेक्स (सीएससी) वेबसाइट <http://www.csircmc.res.in> पर जाएं तथा होम पेज पर "CAREERS" विकल्प पर क्लिक करें।
For more details please visit CSIR Madras Complex (CMC) website <http://www.csircmc.res.in> and click on "CAREERS" from the Home Page.

प्रशासिक अधिकारी / Administrative Officer

GOVERNMENT OF RAJASTHAN
DISTRICT SUPPLY OFFICE, ALWAR

Email- dsofood-ALW-rj@nic.in Phone No.-0144-2344553
क्रमांक-307 दिनांक-20/05/2026

Notice Inviting Bid

e-Bids for selection of Handling and Transportation of Food grains Under PDS from FCI Depots in District ALWAR are invited from interested bidders up to **Date 10/06/2026 Time 12:00 pm** Other particulars of the bid may be viewed on the procurement portal (<http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in> or <http://sppa.rajasthan.gov.in>) of the state. The approximate value of the procurement is **5.00 crore** for One year.

NIB No- FCC2627A0037
UBN No-FCC2627SLOB00036 District Supply Officer
DIPRC/9038/2026 ALWAR

The Andhra Pradesh Mineral Development Corporation Limited
Door No. 294/1D, 100 feet Road (Tadigadapa to Enikepadu Road),
Kanuru, Vijayawada-521137, Andhra Pradesh, India
Tel: +91-866-2429999 Fax: +91-866-2429977 Email: contracts-ho@apmdc.in

Tender Notice

Ref: **APMDC/P&C/CAMC IT Hardware/SCM/2026-27/1**, Date: **26.05.2026**,
APMDC invites E-tender from reputed Agencies for "Selection of Provision of Comprehensive Annual Maintenance Contract (CAMC) for the Existing IT Hardware Infrastructure & Devices at APMDC Suliwari Coal Project, Madhya Pradesh". For more information on the eligibility criteria, tender fees, timelines and other details, please visit APMDC website (www.apmdc.ap.gov.in). The Tender document is available for downloading from APMDC website from **26.05.2026 and the last date for submission of bid is 15.06.2026**.

Place: Vijayawada Date : 26.05.2026
DIPR 5108PP/CL DT.25-05-2026

Sd/- Managing Director
The A. P. Mineral Development Corporation Limited

Office of the Additional Chief Engineer (Project) PHED Ajmer
Qtr. No. II/2, PHED Colony, Vaishali Nagar, near RIICO Watch Factory,
Ph. No. 0145-2640265, email: acepajmer@gmail.com acepajm.phed@rajasthan.gov.in

S.No. F(JACE/Proj)/AJ/AR-JJM /2026-27/1057 Date: 20.05.2026

CORRIGENDUM NO.5

NIB Code:- **PHE2526A6441 & UBN No. PHE2526WLOB13856**

In continuation to this NIT No.03/2025-26 issued vide letter no. 2436-2491 dated 11.02.2026. The following amendment are hereby notified:-

S.N.	Description	As per original NIT & Corrigendum 4	As per this corrigendum
1	Date & time for downloading of tender document	13.02.2026 at 10:00 AM to 21.05.2026 up to 06:00 PM	13.02.2026 at 10:00 AM to 11.06.2026 up to 6:00 PM
2	Date & time for online submission of tender	From 24.02.2026 at 10:00 AM to up to 21.05.2026 at 6:00 PM	Up to 11.06.2026 at 06:00 PM
3	Date & time of physical submission of tender fee, RLSL charges and EMD	22.05.2026 at 01:00 PM	Up to 12.06.2026 at 01:00 PM
4	Date & time of opening of technical bid	22.05.2026 at 03:00 PM	Up to 12.06.2026 at 03:00 PM

All other terms and conditions shall remain same as mentioned in tender document.

(Krishan Kumar Agarwal)
Additional Chief Engineer (Project) PHED, Ajmer

DIPRC/9057/2026

Government of Kerala
Published Tenders from 21-05-2026 to 24-05-2026
Ground Water Department
Tender ID: 2026_GWD_851963_1 • District Officer • Supply and commissioning of rig units for Wayanad District u •
Closing Date: 19-Jun-2026 • PAC: Rs22500000
Visit <https://etenders.kerala.gov.in> for more details.
Ro.No:21-24/May/2026/PRD/N/6

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OFFICE OF THE CHIEF GENERAL MANAGER (P&C) IDCCO, IDCO TOWER, BHUBANESWAR

Tender Call Notice No, File No.: IDCCO/HO-P&C/A-100869/04/2026/V-1 14331, Dated : 20.05.2026

NOTICE INVITING TENDER THROUGH e-PROCUREMENT

Name of the Work : SITC of 33 kV UG Cable (1C x 630 Sqmm XLPE) for Connectivity of 33/11 kV, 2 x 8 MVA Primary Substation (PSS) from 33 kV Source and SITC of 11 kV UG Cable (3Cx 400 Sqmm XLPE) for Distribution of Load at Ramdaspur Electrical Estate under Electrical Section, Godisahi, Cuttack.
Estimated Cost put to tender : Rs.1,28,25,992.00
Period of completion : 4(Four) Calendar Months

Procurement Officer	Bid Identification No.	Availability of Tender On-Line for Bidding	
		From	To
1	2	3	4
Chief General Manager (P&C), IDCCO, IDCO Tower, Bhubaneswar	Bid Identification No. P&C/EST/E-06/2026-27	17.00 hours of dt.26.05.2026	17.00 hours of dt.10.06.2026

Further details can be seen from the e-Procurement Portal www.Tendersodisha.gov.in and Corrigendum if any will be published in newspapers and can only be seen in the e-procurement portal as well as in IDCO website.

Sd/- Chief General Manager (P&C), IDCCO, Bhubaneswar
4001/109/2627 OIPR-4001/4075/1/26-27/0034

JAC DELHI-2026

Admission Notice for B.Tech. & B.Arch. Programmes 2026-2027

ONLINE applications are invited for admission to B. Tech. and B.Arch. programmes offered by the following Universities/Institutes established by the Government of NCT of Delhi:

- Netaji Subhas University of Technology (NSUT), www.nsut.ac.in
- Delhi Technological University (DTU), www.dtu.ac.in
- Indira Gandhi Delhi Technical University for Women (IGDTUW), www.igdtuw.ac.in
- Indraprastha Institute of Information Technology Delhi (IIIT-D), www.iiitd.ac.in
- Delhi Skill and Entrepreneurship University (DSEU), www.dseu.ac.in

For detailed information regarding eligibility criteria, reservation policy, admission procedure, counselling schedule, application process, seat matrix, and other admission-related guidelines, candidates are advised to visit: jacdelhi.admissions.nic.in

ONLINE Application Process

- Candidates must register ONLINE through the JAC Delhi Admission Portal as per the instructions given in the Admission Brochure available on the portal.
- A non-refundable registration fee of Rs. 1500/- is to be paid ONLINE only through Credit Card / Debit Card / Net Banking / UPI / or any other online payment mode available on the portal.
- Candidates are advised to regularly visit the JAC Delhi website for updates and important announcements regarding the admission process.

Important Dates

1.	Commencement of Online Registration and Choice Filling.	May 28, 2026 (Thursday) from 10:00 AM
2.	Last Date and time for Online Registration (Registration Form Filling, Registration Fee Payment and Choice filling).	June 09, 2026 (Tuesday) Till 11:30 PM

HELP DESK : helpdesk.jacdelhi2026@nsut.ac.in
Note :- Application received without prescribed fee shall not be considered / summarily rejected.

DIP/Shabdarth/Classified/0069/26-27 Chairperson, JAC Delhi-2026

VATICAN CITY

Pope makes historic apology for Vatican's role in justifying slavery



REUTERS

Pope Leo XIV on Monday issued an unprecedented apology for the Vatican's role in justifying slavery and said the delay in condemning it was "a wound in Christian memory". Past Popes have apologised for Christians' involvement in the slave trade. But Leo's words went further by mentioning the Church's role in legitimising slavery. AFP

ISTANBUL

Jailed Kurdish leader says 'no time to lose' for Turkiye peace process



AFP

Jailed PKK founder Abdullah Ocalan warned against any delay in taking legal steps to flesh out the peace process with Ankara, in a message on Monday. Mr. Ocalan said prolonging the peace process would only "generate risk". Last year, the Kurdistan Workers' Party (PKK) formally renounced its armed struggle after four decades. AFP

CAIRO

Israeli attack kills two, including six-year-old girl, in Gaza: medics



AP

An Israeli airstrike on a tent encampment of displaced families in the southern Gaza Strip on Monday killed two people including a six-year-old girl and wounded 17 people, Palestinian health officials said. The attack was carried out by two helicopters. The Israeli Army said it had struck militants but provided no information. REUTERS

ISLAMABAD

Death toll climbs to more than 30 in Pakistan train bombing: officials



REUTERS

The death toll in the suicide bombing of a train carrying security personnel in the Pakistani province of Balochistan the day before rose to more than 30, officials said on Monday. The separatist group Baloch Liberation Army (BLA) claimed the car bomb attack in the provincial capital Quetta. REUTERS

Iran says progress on several issues, but agreement with U.S. not yet close

Tehran talks down hopes of imminent peace deal with U.S.; Iran official says 'conclusion reached on a large portion of the issues under discussion'; Iranian state media reports officials on a visit to Qatar as part of 'diplomatic process' to end war

Agence France-Presse
TEHRAN

Iran warned on Monday that, while some progress had been made, it was not yet close to striking a deal with the United States to end the war in West Asia, after a weekend of mixed messages from Washington and Tehran.

World oil prices tumbled on renewed optimism about an agreement, after top U.S. diplomat Marco Rubio suggested a deal could be reached within the day but a top Iranian official responded: "No one can make such a claim."



REUTERS

Beneath the calm: Vessels sailing through the Strait of Hormuz, as seen from Musandam, Oman, on Monday.

"We thought we might have some news last night, maybe today," U.S. Secretary of State Rubio told reporters during a visit to New Delhi, referring to hopes for a deal.

But in Tehran, Foreign Ministry spokesman Esmail Baqaei poured cold water on hopes for a quick final settlement.

"It is correct to say that we have reached a conclu-

sion on a large portion of the issues under discussion," he told a weekly news briefing. "But to say that this means the signing of an agreement is imminent — no one can make such a claim."

Service fees in Hormuz

Mr. Baqaei stressed that Iran would continue to manage maritime traffic through the Strait of Hormuz by charging service fees. "The services that are provided — navigational services in addition to the measures necessary to protect the environment of the Strait of Hormuz, the Persian Gulf and the Sea of Oman — require the collec-

tion of certain fees," he said.

Earlier, U.S. President Donald Trump had said that he had told his negotiators "not to rush into a deal, in that time is on our side", and warned that the U.S. naval blockade would remain in place until a deal was reached.

Meanwhile, Iran's top negotiator Mohammad Bagher Ghalibaf arrived in Qatar on Monday, state media reported. A delegation headed by "Mr. Ghalibaf, travelled to Doha today. This trip comes as part of the diplomatic process", said the official IRNA news agency, adding that talks will be held to end the war.

Xi praises peace efforts, hails 'unbreakable' China-Pak. ties

Reuters
BEIJING

President Xi Jinping hailed China's "unbreakable" friendship with Pakistan on Monday as he met Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif in Beijing, seeking to deepen their "all-weather" partnership. Mr. Xi welcomed the Pakistani leader as an "old friend" and said the two countries had "understood, trusted and supported each other" over decades.

Pakistan is among an exclusive group of countries which China regards as an "all-weather strategic partner", spanning close economic, trade and security cooperation. But Islamist militant attacks on Chinese nationals and projects in southwest Pakistan where China has big infras-



REUTERS

Bilateral push: Pakistani Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif meets Chinese President Xi Jinping in Beijing on Monday.

tructure investments have irked Beijing.

"No matter how the international situation changes, China always prioritises the development of its ties with Pakistan in its neighbourhood diplomacy," Mr. Xi said.

Mr. Sharif, in turn, called China and Pakistan two "iron brother" coun-tries with a relationship

that is "next to none". Mr. Sharif was accompanied by Pakistan's Army chief, Asim Munir, who was recently in Tehran for meet-ings with Iran's leadership.

"I know that you have just returned from Iran and made positive efforts for the current peace. We appreciate the construc-tive role played by Pakis-tan," Mr. Xi said.

Netanyahu orders military to intensify offensive in Lebanon

Agence France-Presse
JERUSALEM

Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu said on Monday he had ordered the military to intensify its offensive in Lebanon in an effort to "crush" Hezbollah, accusing the group of targeting Israeli forces with drone attacks.

"I have ordered an even greater acceleration of our operations," Mr. Netanyahu said on Telegram.

"It is true that they are attacking us with drones, but we have teams working on countermeasures and

we will solve this issue... We will intensify our blows, increase our fire-power, and we will crush them."

These comments were made despite a U.S.-brokered ceasefire and follow calls by far-right Ministers Itamar Ben Gvir and Bezalel Smotrich to escalate military operations, with Mr. Smotrich advocating "strikes on capital Beirut".

A total of 24 Israelis have been killed since hostilities began on March 2. Lebanon's Health Ministry has put the overall death toll in the war at 3,123.

Eight killed after Russia and Ukraine exchange missile and drone attacks

Reuters
MOSCOW/KYIV

At least eight people have been killed in missile and drone attacks on Russian and Ukrainian territory in the past 24 hours, local authorities on both sides said on Monday, with damage reported to energy infrastructure in Russia's Belgorod region.

The barrage came days after Russia accused Kyiv of striking a vocational school in the Russian-occupied Lugansk region, killing 21 people. Russian President Vladimir Putin ordered his military to retaliate for that attack. Uk-



AFP

In the aftermath: A worker takes part in repair work on a damaged residential building following Russian strikes in Kyiv on Monday.

raine's military denied the accusations and said it had struck an elite drone command unit in the area.

Since then, four people, including two teenagers, have been killed in the Rus-

sian-controlled Ukrainian town of Horlivka, its Mayor Ivan Prikhodko said on Monday, blaming Ukrainian armed aggression.

In Russia's Belgorod region, one man was killed

and another injured in a missile and drone attack that also cut power and water supplies, local authorities said on Telegram.

In Ukraine, two people were killed and 16 wounded in Russian shelling, missile and drone attacks in Kherson over the past 24 hours, regional Governor Oleksandr Prokudin said.

In another attack near Kharkiv, Ukraine's second biggest city, one person was killed and two were injured. The regional Governor said that according to preliminary information, Russia carried out a missile attack on the town of Derhachi, just outside the city.

Iran says Supreme Leader suffered only 'superficial' wounds

Agence France-Presse
TEHRAN

The injuries suffered by Supreme Leader Ayatollah Mojtaba Khamenei in U.S.-Israeli strikes in late February were only "superficial", an Iranian Health Ministry official said on Monday. The 56-year-old has not appeared publicly since he was named as Iran's new leader on March 8, issuing only written statements, fuelling speculation about his health.

In March, U.S. Defence Secretary Pete Hegseth said Mr. Mojtaba was "be-

lieved to be alive, wounded and disfigured".

On Monday, Health Ministry spokesman Hossein Kermanpour described the day Mr. Mojtaba was wounded. He said Mr. Mojtaba arrived at a hospital on February 28 and "entered the operating room along with several other wounded individuals."

"Apart from superficial injuries to the face, head and legs, which caused neither amputation nor any particular medical problem, nothing major had happened," Mr. Kermanpour said.

Sport

It would be 'supercool' to have the World title decider in India, reckons Gukesh

CHESS

C. Shyam Sundar
OSLO

He is the World champion alright, but has copped a lot of criticism in the recent past over his performances after ascending the throne. Yet, D. Gukesh is calm personified as he handles the flak he faces over his patchy form.

Here in the Norwegian capital to play the Norway Chess tournament, the Indian, who will turn 20 on May 29, handled questions about the dip in his form over the past 18 months or so with quiet assurance.

"I have not been performing well in the last one-and-a-half years and I



FLICKR/NORWAY CHESS

No worries: Gukesh is not overtly concerned about the chatter surrounding his patchy form in the recent past.

think I would say that my performances have been way below expectations. They (critics) have the right to say what they feel and I have the right to do my best," Gukesh said

ahead of the prestigious event.

He said he would be happy to play the World Championship match anywhere, but admitted that it would be special if it

was to be held in India, even though the pressure of defending the title at home would be immense.

"Anywhere would be nice... In India there's always a lot of pressure. The World Championships will attract a lot of attention. If it's in India it will be super-cool and I will be very happy," he added.

Asked if he would like to see a repeat of the incident where Magnus Carlsen banged the table after a loss to him in the tournament last year, Gukesh said chess players generally don't show a lot of emotions but when it did happen, a lot of people got attracted to chess."

(The writer is in Oslo at the invitation of Norway Chess).

Magnus Carlsen — understanding the aura of a Norwegian sporting superstar

C. Shyam Sundar
OSLO

There's something about Magnus Carlsen. Like him or hate him, the Norwegian chess superstar is hard to ignore.

He's probably the greatest sports icon in a nation where football rules the popularity charts and is most spoken about with the FIFA World Cup on the horizon.

The 35-year-old is the player to beat every time he sits at the board — irrespective of the format.

It's no different at Norway Chess with people — right from the tournament director Kjell Madland to the denizens — rooting for Carlsen in his home event.

"Of course, it's a huge



FLICKR/NORWAY CHESS

Carlsen.

thing that Norway has a player like Magnus," said Madland, adding "It's not easy to understand his im-

It's not easy to understand his impact. And of course, replacing him is not going to be easy

— KJELL MADLAND, tournament director

And of course, replacing him is not going to be easy."

Meanwhile, a young man, who was helping his little son move giant chess pieces on an oversized board at Deichman Bjørvika where the prestigious event is being held, said Carlsen's exploits over the years have been phenomenal and felt his fame had probably reduced because

he made winning a habit. "But years ago, when he started winning world titles for the first time, Carlsen was probably even more popular because it was all new," he said.

Staff at the Scandic hotel here said it was hard to think the local hero could be beaten.

"You cannot beat him here. That's unthinkable," said Gustav Nerland, receptionist at the hotel and a huge fan of the World No. 1.

His colleague Eiler Kongsrud nodded in agreement and said "Magnus is a great champion."

There is something about Carlsen which continues to befuddle his opponents and ensures his long-running supremacy.

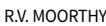
Pacers are forced to work hard, don't get extra cushion: Patidar



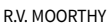
'It's not easy for a spinner in this format... Rashid has been top class'



Skipper Rahane proud of the way KKR never stopped fighting



Capitals undone by inconsistency and missed moments: Badani



A spot in the final up for grabs, RCB runs into well-drilled GT

Salt is fit, but we are yet to decide our combination: Patidar

A CH-CHE

Sensational slide, rampaging comeback and nail-biting finish

In the race to the IPL 2026 playoffs, Punjab were duly punished after suffering six successive losses while Kolkata kept themselves alive until the last day; those who did not make the top-four cut will look back at missed opportunities

R. Kaushik

And then there were four. It wasn't until the 69th, and penultimate, match of the 10-team league phase that the final qualifier for the IPL 2026 playoffs was identified. Sunrisers Hyderabad's 55-run defeat of defending champions Royal Challengers Bengaluru on Friday had cemented the top three; the holders and table-toppers would take on Gujarat Titans, the 2022 champions, in Qualifier 1. Hyderabad, who like the top two also ended up with 18 points, had earned their place in the Eliminator, waiting to see who their opponents were.

When Shreyas Iyer blasted his maiden century against Lucknow Super Giants on Saturday to arrest an alarming slide of six straight losses and keep Punjab Kings in the hunt, the wait for the fourth qualifier spilled over to the final day of league action, in keeping with the IPL's reputation and history. In the end, after a start-stop-start season, Rajasthan Royals, champions in the inaugural edition in 2008, earned that right following a 30-run conquest of Mumbai Indians under a blazing afternoon sun at the Wankhede Stadium.

As is inevitably the case, those that missed out on qualification narrowly - Punjab finished on 15 points, Delhi Capitals on 14 while 16 was the magic figure on which Rajasthan rode into the last four - will rue missed opportunities, a game that slid by here, a point that was dropped there. Kings will potentially point to the only no-result of the tournament, against Kolkata Knight Riders at Eden Gardens, as a decisive moment.

Struggling at the time to get on the points table, Ajinkya Rahane's men, strangely opting to bat despite the threat of rain, were gasping at 25 for two when the skies opened up, gifting them a much-needed first point. Who's to say how the match would have panned out had PBKS, riding the crest of an early wave, had the opportunity to play out a full game?

Kings will look back and understandably wonder how it came to this pass. For the first half, and more, of the league phase, they looked unstoppable and unbeatable. The no-result in Kolkata was the only point they dropped in their first seven outings; with 13 points and seven games remaining, it wasn't a question of whether they would make the playoffs, but what their final points tally would be and who they might run into in Qualifier 1.

Inexorable tailspin

Then, remarkably, without warning, Punjab embarked on an inexorable tailspin, the celebrated leadership group of Shreyas and head coach Ricky Ponting powerless to arrest the slide.

The same personnel that fuelled their first-half charge started to repeatedly fluff their lines, their death bowling went to pieces and their catching and ground fielding was abysmal. The last development would have particularly incensed Ponting, for two reasons - one, he was among the best fielders of his generation and two, misfields and dropped catches are unforgivable unforced errors.

PBKS have plenty of time - nearly 10 months - to rue their self-inflicted misfortune and reflect on how they managed to embrace elimination when advancing to the next stage was infinitely the simpler and more inviting proposition. Shreyas had a great run with the bat and was tactically astute for the most part - at one point, there were calls



The good news - for everyone else except the bowling fraternity - is that more of Sooryavanshi is in store. He showed that he wasn't an otherworldly being thrust upon us with a six-ball four against MI on Sunday, but that means he will be even more charged up against Sunrisers in New Chandigarh on Wednesday



Hit and miss: Sooryavanshi has lit up the tournament with his swashbuckling strokeplay while Miller and Delhi were left to rue the South African's 'brain-fade' moment against Gujarat. SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

better than Abhishek Sharma's 206.22 and these two left-handers also have the most sixes where, again, Sooryavanshi is clearly streets ahead, with 53 'maximums' to the Hyderabad opener's 43. Wednesday will therefore witness a battle within a battle, with the winner living to fight another night and vanquished taking an early flight home.

The two leading scorers of the competition are Gujarat's Sai Sudharsan and Gill, with 638 and 616 runs respectively. But interestingly, as if to reinforce the belief that batters win matches while bowlers win tournaments, the GT bowling unit has accounted for more than 100 wickets, making them the only franchise to top that milestone this edition. Their charge has been led by the excellent Kagiso Rabada and the terrific Afghan leg-spinner Rashid Khan, who has purged a lean last couple of years with 19 wickets to go with an economy of 8.71. Rabada's 24 wickets are the joint highest alongside Bhuvneshwar Kumar, the ageless wonder from RCB who holds the Purple Cap owing to a superior economy rate of 8.07 compared to his South African counterpart's 9.18.

Rabada and Mohammed Siraj, who has picked up 17 wickets, are in a personal battle for the most dot balls bowled in the competition. Between them, the Rabada-Rashid-Siraj trio has 60 wickets which, allied with Prasad's 14 and Jason Holder's 13, paint the picture of a wicket-hungry group that has backed up the heroics of their openers and the explosive No. 3, Jos Buttler.

Maximising their depth

RCB have just one bowler in the top 12 wicket-takers and one batter - Virat Kohli, at ninth, with 557 runs - in the top 15 run-makers, but clearly, they have maximised their depth in both departments, which explains their status as the table-toppers.

They were forced to split the opening combine of Kohli and Phil Salt after the latter picked up a finger injury, and Salt's replacement, Jacob Bethell, has flown back home, also with a finger injury. In their absence, Venkatesh Iyer has stepped up nicely, while at No. 3, Devdutt Padikkal has been wonderful to watch with his rangy ball-striking and a rejigged mindset that's allowed him to score at 171.82.

Rajat Patidar, who ended a long wait by leading the team to their first trophy last season, has scored 393 runs at a strike-rate of 183.64 while Tim David is a dangerously fierce middle-order presence. This is the fulcrum around which the batting has revolved, while the bowling has been shored up, in Bhuvneshwar's wake, by Rasikh Salam and the crafty Krunal Pandya, though Hazlewood has blown hot and cold.

All to play for as we head to the final week then. Bengaluru and Gujarat will have two bites at the cherry by finishing 1-2, while Hyderabad and Rajasthan are at the point of no return. It's taken nearly two months to reach this stage; now, it's all about the next six nights.

Five-time champions Mumbai Indians were the biggest disappointment, reiterating that big names and celebrity superstars don't guarantee success. Lucknow Super Giants weren't much better

for his elevation to T20I captaincy at the expense of the misfiring Suryakumar Yadav, though those calls have disappeared now - but the end result is something he will struggle to reconcile with.

Delhi fell tantalisingly short numerous times in closing out games, not least against Gujarat when they needed two runs off as many deliveries with David Miller and Kuldeep Yadav in the middle. For reasons best known to him, the South African turned down the scores-tying single off the penultimate ball from Prasad's Krishna, backing himself to get the job done.

It was a massive error in judgement and DC paid a heavy immediate and eventual price. Kuldeep was run out off the last ball looking for the bye that would have sent the game into a Super Over as Gujarat pulled off a one-run heist. From then on, one of only two from the original eight - apart from Punjab - to have not won the title even once blew hot and cold, struggling for consistency and crashing out despite bringing the curtain down on the league phase with a comprehensive victory over Kolkata on Sunday.

So much for the two that narrowly missed out. KKR and Chennai Super Kings recovered from early setbacks to stay in touch with the qualification race, though they were always chasing their tails and playing catch-up. The same couldn't be said of the two cellar teams, Mumbai Indians and Lucknow Super Giants, both of whom managed a frugal four wins each from 14 outings. Five-time champions Mumbai were the biggest disappointment, reiterating that big names and celebrity superstars don't guarantee success.

Lucknow are now licking their wounds and already contemplating changes, including to their leadership after ₹27 crore-signing Rishabh Pant had another modest season with the bat and has now led the side to just 10 wins from 28 outings across two campaigns. Left-handed batters (mainly openers)

and fast bowlers stole the individual honours, none more so than the youngest player in the history of the competition. Vaibhav Sooryavanshi rang in his 15th birthday just a day before IPL 2026 got underway on March 28. He celebrated that milestone in extraordinary fashion, sending chills down the spine of some of the most illustrious bowlers of the modern era. He instilled fear and uncertainty, he mesmerised and entertained with an array of strokes that screamed out intrepidity and great class. He spared no one - not Josh Hazlewood or Jasprit Bumrah, not Kagiso Rabada or Mitchell Starc. When was the last time you watched a match just for one player? And that too for a 15-year-old?

The good news - for everyone else except the bowling fraternity - is that more of Sooryavanshi is in store. He showed that he wasn't an otherworldly being thrust upon us with a six-ball four against MI on Sunday, but that means he will be even more charged up against Sunrisers in New Chandigarh on Wednesday.

Already this season, he has had two interesting run-ins with the 2016 winners. In Hyderabad a month and a half ago, he perished first ball, caught on the pull off debutant pacer Praful Hinge. Retribution was swift, and just 12 days in coming. In the return fixture in Jaipur, he brought up the third fastest IPL century, off 36 deliveries (he holds the record for the second fastest too, let's not forget), treating Praful with disdain and battering Sakib Hussain, who had also taken four wickets on his debut alongside his pace partner.

Hyderabad won both those games, by 57 runs and five wickets, but captain Pat Cummins and head coach Daniel Vettori will read nothing into those results as they head into the first actual knockout game of the competition. They know there's more to RR than Sooryavanshi - yes, though it's easy to lose track of that sometimes - but much of their focus will be concentrated on halting the boy wonder because, well, he is the boy wonder.

Topping the charts

Sooryavanshi finished the league stage as the fifth highest scorer, with 583 runs, behind only Sai Sudharsan, Shubman Gill, Heinrich Klaasen and K.L. Rahul. Among those with more than 400 runs, he is one of only two batters with a strike rate of more than 200; his 232.27 is comfortably

THE GIST

Punjab will wonder how they were eliminated. For the first half, and more, of the league phase, they looked unstoppable and unbeatable

Kolkata and Chennai recovered from early setbacks to stay in touch with the qualification race, though they were always playing catch-up. The same couldn't be said about Mumbai and Lucknow

In the playoffs, Bengaluru and Gujarat will have two bites at the cherry after finishing 1-2, while Hyderabad and Rajasthan are at the point of no return

Physicists are finding new ways to make electrons act strangely

Science advances when scientists recreate what they find in nature in new conditions; that is how we got air travel, lasers, nuclear power, antibiotics, and semiconductors; something similar maybe happening with quantum materials – materials whose properties arise from quantum physics effects

Vasudevan Mukunth

For most of the last two centuries, we have not had to think much about electricity. At the start of this period, we were just beginning to understand what it was. And towards the end, climate change and renewable energy have rendered it a constant thought in our minds. But for many decades in between, we could take it for granted.

Electricity, most of the time, was just something behind a switch. If you flipped the switch, electrons would move through a wire. If you raised the voltage, more current would flow.

But today, there is another way in which some people are thinking about electrons – a way that could, someday, change the future.

Scientists have found that inside some materials, in extreme conditions, electricity behaves in highly unusual ways. The electrons stop being independent particles and begin moving together. They flow around edges with uncanny precision. Most of all, the particles seem split up into pieces, each apparently carrying a fraction of an electron's charge.

From ramp to staircase

Physics has made many weird discoveries – but a real contender for its weirdest find is the fractional quantum Hall effect (FQHE), which is where electrons behave in those strange ways.

Recently, physicists were able to make it even stranger by recreating it without one of the conditions they believed to be indispensable for it.

In 1879, the U.S. physicist Edwin Hall found something odd. If electricity flows through a metal plate when a magnetic field is pointing perpendicular to the plate, the current experiences a sideways push. (One reason this was odd was that J.J. Thompson would not discover the electron 18 years later.) Scientists later explained why: the magnetic field pushes moving charges sideways, causing electric charge to pile up on the plate's edges, creating a voltage across the metal. This came to be called the Hall effect. The compass in your smartphone uses it to point north.

As usual, the rise of quantum mechanics complicated the picture. In the early 1980s, physicists were studying very clean materials at temperatures just a fraction above absolute zero, using magnetic fields.

When they increased the strength of the field beyond a point, the resistance the current was experiencing – called the Hall resistance – stopped changing smoothly.

Instead, it took discrete values. For example, when before it could change from 1 to 1.1 to 1.2 to 1.3 and so on, now it could change only to 1 or 2 or 3 or so on, like climbing stairs rather than being able to use the ramp. In other words, physicists found the resistance became quantised. And they called it the integer quantum Hall effect.

Once again, they soon found an explanation. Normally, the electrons in a material can have a range of energies. But when there is a strong magnetic field acting on them, the range becomes a set of levels, called Landau levels. And the electrons can occupy only these levels. This is like when before a bunch of people in a room could lie down where they wanted – on one of the four beds or on the floor in between – now they could only occupy the beds. In this condition, the material becomes an insulator on the inside and a very good conductor on its boundaries.

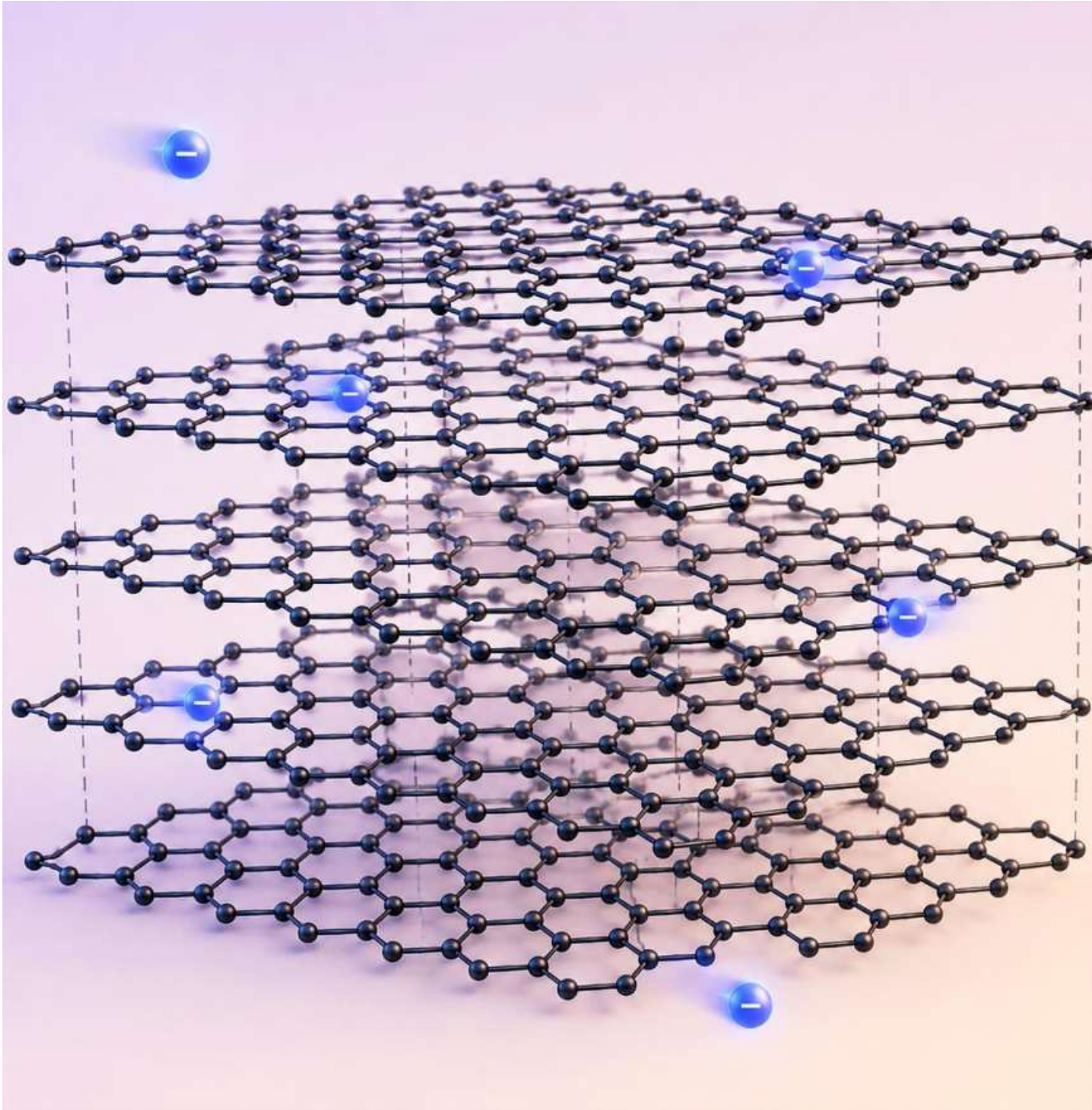
Ocean of electrons

Then, in 1982, physicists found the strangest thing of them all. Sometimes, the Hall resistance occurred only in whole-number steps (1, 2, 3, ...) but sometimes it could occur as fractions: 1/3, 2/5, 3/7, etc. This was FQHE.

(The fraction here refers to the multiple of the material's natural Hall resistance. For example, if the natural resistance is 50 Ω , a fractional Hall resistance of 2/5 implies a measured resistance of 20 Ω .)

At first glance, this should be impossible: electrons are indivisible particles – you cannot break them up into smaller pieces – and each electron carries a fixed amount of electric charge. Yet the Hall resistance seemed to be changing in fractions, as though the current were being carried by objects with only a fraction of an electron's charge. What then was 1/3?

The answer came from quantum



Usually, electrons in a material can zip past each other without also pushing each other apart. But in pentalayer graphene (depicted here), the electrons have such low kinetic energy that the particles' mutual repulsion becomes the dominant interaction between them. IMAGE CREATED WITH CHATGPT 5.2

mechanics. When many electrons come together to interact strongly, they form a collective quantum state – a sort of liquid state in which it is impossible to distinguish individual electrons. This is like an ocean: you cannot isolate the single water droplet you dropped in it. And much like waves in the ocean – where no single droplet travels to the shore but the water as a whole has a moving pattern – a part of the collective quantum state can behave as if it possesses only a fraction of an electron's charge.

Physicists generally call these parts quasiparticles.

In this particular case, the quasiparticles were very unusual. They were of a type called anyons. Which meant they would also have a very unusual property: they would be much more robust than other particles (or quasiparticles) at storing information.

'Faking' a field

However, there is a big practical problem. The FQHE gives rise to anyonic quasiparticles.

But to create the effect, physicists need to apply a very strong magnetic field to the material – sometimes even stronger than the one in a hospital MRI scanner. And the material had to be very clean (i.e. almost entirely free of impurities) and held at close to absolute zero.

Try as they might for no less than four decades, physicists found that this was the only way to create the FQHE. Obviously this is not practical.

FQHE – but especially the anyons it gives rise to – could help quantum computers of the future protect information from noise, which is one of the enterprise's hardest unsolved problems today.

In 2025, Microsoft said it had built a quantum computing chip that created anyons using a different technique, and used them to store and manipulate information.

(However, many scientists doubt the company's claims: among other concerns, questions linger about whether the chip really contains anyons and the means by which that can be verified.)

A sandwich for electrons

One breakthrough came in 2024. It was based on doing something really clever, if also very sophisticated: if a strong magnetic field organises a material's electrons in unusual patterns, could the field's role be 'faked' from within the

Scientists have found that inside some materials, in extreme conditions, electricity behaves in highly unusual ways. The electrons stop being independent particles and begin moving together like a fluid

material itself?

Turns out the answer is 'yes' if the material is graphene. Graphene is a sheet of carbon atoms arranged in a honeycomb pattern. Since the 2000s, physicists have found that if you stack one layer of graphene on another and turn it by a small angle – i.e. twisted bilayer graphene – the electrons in the stack behave oddly.

The grid of atoms in this structure forms what is called a moiré superlattice, which essentially significantly slows the electrons down. When the electrons slowed down, they formed a (strongly) collective quantum state – the kind of state that gave rise to the FQHE earlier. But this time there was no magnetic field; the moiré superlattice had recreated the field's requisite effects.

Twisted bilayer graphene has many odd electronic properties. However, it does not slow electrons down enough to create a sufficiently robust collective quantum state.

Usually, electrons in a material are zipping around with enough kinetic energy for them to ignore their mutual repulsion. This does not mean they clump together – more like they can zip past each other without also pushing each other apart.

On the other hand, the FQHE demands that the electrons' mutual repulsion must be the stronger force. For that, the electrons need to slow down beyond a specific point, and twisted bilayer graphene was not really creating the conditions for that.

Enter pentalayer graphene. After many experiments, physicists found that when they added more graphene layers to the stack, the electrons slowed down more.

With five layers – with each layer turned by a small angle relative to the one below – placed atop a substrate of hexagonal boron nitride, the electrons' kinetic energy dropped enough for electron-electron interactions to become dominant.

(Aside: If the electrons are repelling each other in this state, how come they

form a collective quantum state instead of flying apart? When electrons are repelling each other but are also confined, they do not have the luxury of flying apart. Instead, they organise themselves better, leading to the collective quantum state – sort of like a negotiated settlement where they agree to not antagonise each other.)

Quantum materials

In 2024, a team lead by Long Ju at the Massachusetts Institute of Technology reported that it had detected FQHE in pentalayer graphene. They called it the FQAHE – the 'A' stood for anomalous, meaning it had been achieved without using a magnetic field.

The team reported observing Hall resistance like 2/3 and 3/5.

They concluded that the moiré superlattice created by five layers of graphene had produced the requisite structural features mimicking the effects of a magnetic field.

The experimental observation of FQAHE does not mean the underlying science is ready for real-world use.

With or without magnetic fields, physicists still need the material to be ultra-clean and work with it at very low temperature.

They also need to get the angles at which the graphene layers are turned relative to the substrate very close. Even a small deviation can destroy the ideal moiré superlattice properties required to slow and confine the electrons.

Finally, the FQAHE also appears only when the material contains the 'right' number of electrons, which physicists can control by applying the right amount of voltage.

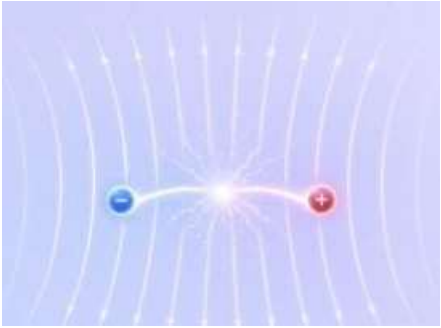
Since then, by fine-tuning these controls, physicists have found ways to create more robust FQAHE states.

Many of them keep going because of the value the anyonic quasiparticles hold for more advanced quantum computers – and indeed a whole world of physics that was previously locked behind powerful yet expensive magnets.

But more than that, science also advances when scientists recreate what they find in nature in new conditions. That is how we got air travel, lasers, nuclear power, antibiotics, and semiconductors.

Something similar may be happening now with quantum materials – materials whose properties arise from quantum physics effects.

mukunth.v@thehindu.co.in



An electromagnetic field can stir up a pair of subatomic particles from the vacuum at very high energy. IMAGE CREATED WITH CHATGPT 5.2

Tech needed to create matter from light in place

Vasudevan Mukunth

Matter can become energy. You might have seen this in the film Oppenheimer or in videos of nuclear explosions. Just as the nuclei fuse, a blinding light fills the air and sky, so bright that simply closing your eyelids does not help.

Physics allows physicists to do the opposite as well: to create matter from light. The problem is the scale at which the required technologies need to work. Scientists need to pack a great quantity of light into a really small volume of space, and hold it there for long enough for the light to 'condense' into matter.

Specifically, scientists need to create extremely intense electromagnetic fields (photons are packets of electromagnetic energy).

Recently, researchers from Germany, Ireland, the U.K., and the U.S. reported clearing a key technical hurdle on the path to doing so. Their findings were published in *Nature*.

Scientists need to pack a great quantity of light into a really small volume of space, and hold it there for long enough for the light to 'condense' into matter

The theory that describes how light and matter interact is called quantum electrodynamics (QED). Normally, empty space appears empty. But at extremely high energy, QED predicts that a sufficiently powerful electromagnetic field can stir up a pair of subatomic particles from the vacuum. The problem? The strength of the electromagnetic field required far outpaces what current technologies can achieve.

In the new study, the researchers used a different technique. They fired an extremely intense laser pulse at a polished target, immediately parting the atoms in its surface of all their electrons. The electric field in the laser light set the electrons oscillating back and forth at nearly the speed of light. This caused the target's surface to reflect the laser pulse in multiple copies at higher frequencies, called harmonics. Physicists have hoped to further compress these harmonics and focus them into small spots. Such coherent harmonic focusing (CHF) would make the harmonics extremely intense, approaching the levels required to create matter.

But while the idea has been around for two decades, physicists have struggled to realise it efficiently. Previous experiments produced harmonics but with much less energy than in the original pulse.

A pulse's intensity increases from the leading point to its middle, roughly. The time taken for the pulse's peak intensity to enter the target is called its rise time. The authors of the new study reduced the rise time to well under one-trillionth of a second. At peak performance, then, the experiment generated enough energy within the 12th to 47th harmonics to show for the first time that the efficiency required by theory may be within reach.

The authors have stressed that they have not yet demonstrated the final focused state, only that the essential technical ingredients are now in place. At the next generation laser facilities that the U.K. and China, among others, are currently building, the technique is projected to reach an intensity of 10²⁹ W per sq. cm – the threshold where QED effects become apparent.

"The reward would be access to a new regime of physics, where light becomes strong enough to tear down the vacuum and create particles from nothing," Alexander Pukhov, of the University of Dusseldorf and who helped lay the foundations of CHF, told *Physics*.



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Text & Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Persons killed in landslide at illegal gold mining site in Angola

28 At least 28 people died when a landslide hit an illegal gold mining site in Angola's Bengo province, one of the country's deadliest of such accidents. Four were rescued and search operations have now been completed. A boom in unregulated artisanal gold mining, driven by Angola's push to diversify from diamonds, has made such tragedies increasingly likely. REUTERS

Year-on-year GDP growth for Singapore in Q1 of 2026

6 in per cent. Singapore's economy grew six per cent year-on-year in the first quarter, driven by a surge in demand for AI chips, memory components and server parts. As a major electronics hub, the country has benefited from robust AI-related manufacturing and wholesale trade, offsetting risks from the West Asia crisis and rising oil prices. AFP

Tourists stranded at Gulmarg Gondola after a technical fault

300 Around 300 tourists were stranded aboard the Gulmarg Gondola in Jammu and Kashmir on Monday after the cable car system developed technical problems. Operations of both phases were suspended. There were no casualties. Hundreds of tourists were rescued safely by the SDRF, NDRF, police, and army personnel. PTI

Persons killed in train bombing incident in southwest Pakistan

30 At least 30 people were killed when a suicide bomber rammed an explosive-laden vehicle into a shuttle train carrying security personnel and their families in the city of Quetta in southwest Pakistan. The blast derailed coaches and caused major damage. The Baloch Liberation Army claimed responsibility for the attack. REUTERS

NGT penalises DUSIB for lapse in submitting sewage discharge data

50,000 in ₹. A fine of ₹50,000 was imposed by the National Green Tribunal on the Delhi Urban Shelter Improvement Board (DUSIB) for repeatedly failing to submit details of sewage discharge from JJ clusters. An earlier penalty of ₹25,000 was also ignored. PTI
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Why is the Indian rupee falling?

How does a falling rupee affect India's economy? How does a currency's exchange rate shape its balance of payments? To what extent does Foreign Portfolio Investment influence demand for the rupee? What strategic role does the Reserve Bank of India play in preventing the rupee's depreciation?

EXPLAINER

Jayan Jose Thomas

The graph of the Indian rupee has been snaking sharply downward. The rupee-to-dollar exchange rate, or the rupees needed to purchase a U.S. dollar, crossed 96 in May this year. That rate was around 85 a year ago, indicating the rupee's decline in value since then.

Exchange rate is the price that a currency, such as the rupee, commands in the market, relative to the dollar or other currencies. Just as the market price of onions is determined by demand and supply, so is the price of a currency.

What is the impact of trade deficits on the rupee's value?

The demand for the rupee rises with India's exports and falls with imports. When firms in Ludhiana export garments, the dollars or euros they receive from foreign buyers are exchanged for rupees to pay workers and suppliers, thereby increasing demand for the rupee. On the other hand, Indian companies import oil by exchanging rupees for dollars, thereby reducing the demand for the rupee. Rupee demand also declines when we travel abroad and exchange rupees at the airport for the currency of our destination country.

Overall, if India's imports exceed exports, the foreign currency payments it must make to the rest of the world exceed the foreign currency payments it receives. That implies more rupees are exchanged for dollars than dollars are exchanged for rupees, leading to declines in the demand for, and the value of the rupee (requiring more rupees to purchase one dollar).

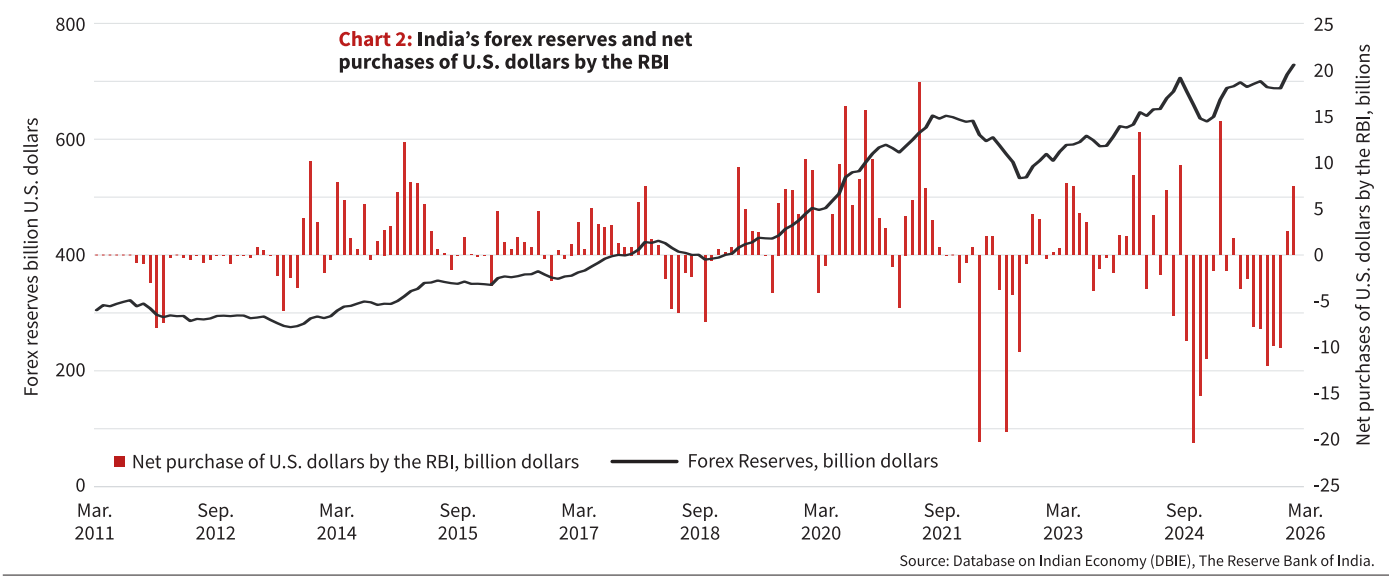
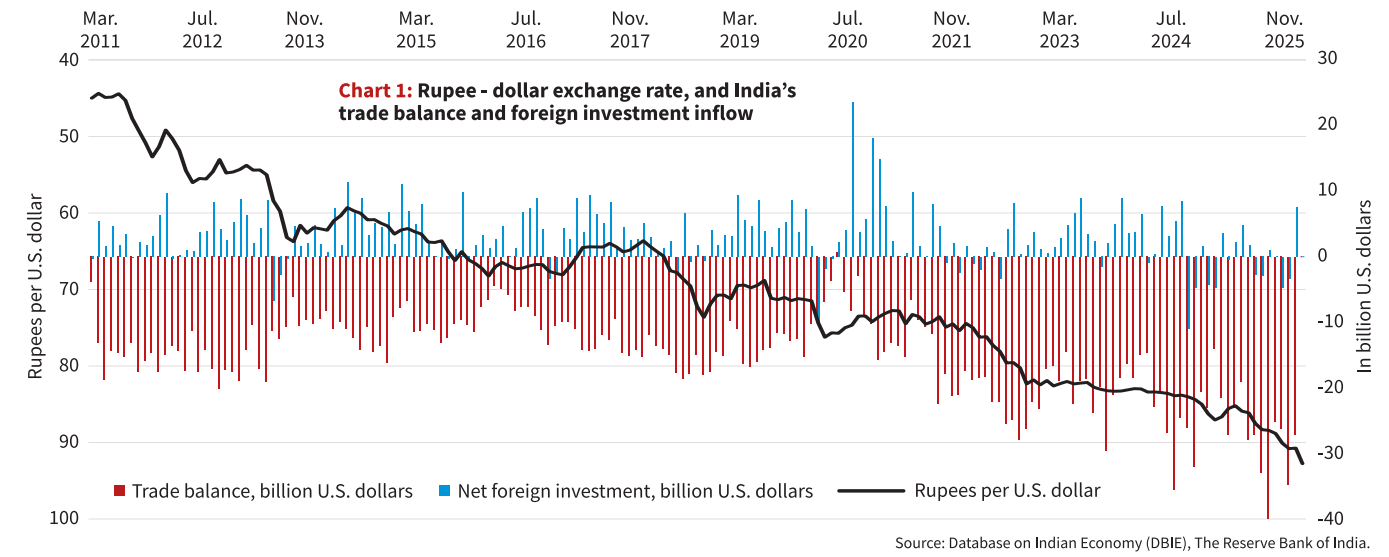
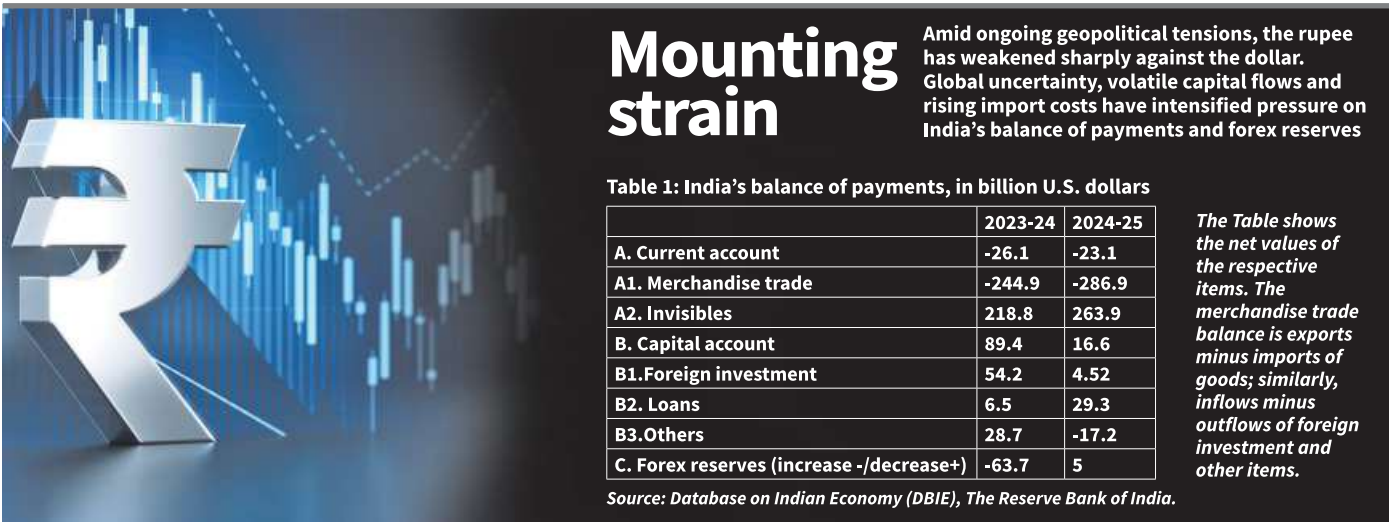
Thus, a currency's exchange rate is closely tied to the country's balance of (foreign currency) payments (to and from the rest of the world). India has consistently run a merchandise trade deficit, with imports of goods (especially oil) exceeding exports. The deficit in its merchandise trade account is partially offset by a surplus in India's invisibles. That is mainly thanks to foreign currency inflows from the export of services, particularly software, and to the large remittance inflows from migrant workers, especially in West Asian countries. Overall, India's current account, which is the sum of merchandise trade and the invisibles accounts, has been in deficit (Table 1).

The gap in the current account, between the foreign currency payments India owes to the rest of the world and the foreign currency payments it receives, has been bridged by inflows through the capital account, mainly foreign investment and loans. If the current account deficit is more than offset by a surplus in the capital account, the excess foreign currency received is added to the country's foreign exchange (or forex) reserves (Table 1).

How do capital outflows weaken the rupee?

A country's forex reserves are as valuable as a family's treasure trove. The reserves are tapped to pay for critical imports during periods of insufficient foreign currency inflows, and to defend the currency's value when capital outflows are too large (discussed below).

Foreign direct investment (FDI) is mostly in new or existing factories and businesses and, as a result, has some ties binding it to the host country. In comparison, foreign portfolio investment



THE GIST

The rupee-to-dollar exchange rate crossed 96 in May this year. A currency's exchange rate reflects the price it commands in the market relative to the dollar and other currencies.

Exchange rate is closely tied to a country's balance of payments. India has consistently run a merchandise trade deficit, with imports — especially oil — exceeding exports.

The depreciation of the rupee imposes significant costs on the Indian economy. Therefore, the country must regulate speculative capital outflows and reduce its dependence on oil imports.

(FPI), which involves purchases of stocks or bonds, is highly volatile and driven by speculation. Portfolio investors enter a country seeking quick financial returns and exit at the first sign of risk or when higher returns are offered elsewhere. When FPI surges in, the stock markets are on a roll; when it flows out, it leaves a trail of destruction. Capital outflows imply that investors withdraw their investments in rupee assets and exchange them for dollar assets, leading to a tumble in demand for the rupee and in its exchange rate.

The periods of rapid depreciation of the Indian rupee have each been characterised by worsening of the trade account, FPI outflows, or both. These include April to September 2013 (when the rupee-to-dollar rate fell from 54.4 to 63.8); January to October 2018 (from 63.6 to 73.6); February to April 2020 (from 71.5 to 76.2); January to October 2022 (from 74.4 to 82.3); September 2024 to February 2025 (from 83.3 to 87.1); and the latest phase that began in May 2025 (from 85.2 to 96) (Chart 1). The recent losses in the

rupee have mainly been due to foreign investors withdrawing from India as they retreat to the safety of their home bases amid growing geopolitical tensions and higher U.S. interest rates.

The depreciation of the rupee imposes a high cost on the Indian economy. To purchase a barrel of oil at \$100, Indian companies now must pay ₹9,600, compared to ₹8,500 had the exchange rate remained at ₹85 per dollar. However, a depressed rupee can help boost exports: a shirt costing ₹1,200 can be sold in the U.S. market at \$12.5 now; if the exchange rate were ₹80 per dollar, the price would have been \$15. But rupee depreciation alone may not help much, given the range of supply and demand constraints weighing on Indian manufacturing.

What is the role of the RBI?

The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) intervenes to prevent the exchange rate from falling to very low levels. When foreign investors rush out by selling their rupee assets for dollars, the RBI props up

the rupee by selling some of the dollars (or treasury bonds) from its reserves. This raises the demand for rupee and slows its decline (as it did during October 2024-January 2025 and August-December 2025) (Chart 2). India's forex reserves remain sufficiently large: they stood at around USD 691.11 billion at the end of March 2026, enough to cover 10.8 months' worth of the country's imports (as of the end of December 2025). That is a mighty armoury the RBI can deploy to shield the rupee against impending speculative tides.

The ongoing geopolitical tensions and the threat of further oil price increases pose severe challenges. India could be at risk of paying more dollars per barrel of oil and more rupees per dollar. The country must take steps to regulate speculative capital outflows and reduce its dependence on oil imports.

(Jayan Jose Thomas is a Professor of Economics at the Indian Institute of Technology, Delhi, and a visiting researcher at the South Asia Institute of the University of Heidelberg.)

